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NEARBY



Preparedness amped up as flu cases cross 4,200

BENGALURU
The Karnataka Health Department has stepped up surveillance and preparedness measures for seasonal influenza, including H1N1, with the State recording 4,212 laboratory-confirmed cases this year across 32 districts till August 22. » PAGE 5

HC stays probe against Bidadi farmers

BENGALURU
The High Court of Karnataka stayed further investigation into a case registered against farmers on the allegation of attempting to murder for protesting with brooms and preventing officials from entering their lands. » PAGE 2

Three newborns killed in Maharashtra hospital fire

36 infants rescued from the SNCU of District Women's Hospital in Amravati; blaze started after a ventilator exploded, say police; seven-member panel to probe the incident, says Health Minister

Yohan Varghese
MUMBAI

Three newborns were killed and 36 rescued after a fire broke out at the Special Newborn Care Unit (SNCU) of the District Women's Hospital in Amravati, Maharashtra, in the early hours of Monday.
The police said the blaze started after a ventilator exploded and caught fire on the third floor of the unit. Six infants were rescued from the affected area, and the flames were doused in 10 to 15 minutes.

At the time of the fire, 39 newborns were admitted to the SNCU, which provides treatment to premature babies and newborns who have low birth weight and are in a critical condition.



Relatives of an infant victim of the fire mourn near the District Women's Hospital in Amravati, Maharashtra, on Monday. PTI

Sources said doctors, nurses, and other hospital staff rushed to the ward after the fire broke out and began evacuating the babies. They disconnected the medical equipment and shifted the infants to safety as rescue operations got under way.

A nurse who was on du-

ty said: "While the ventilator was burning, we removed the babies. I cannot describe it — it was terrible. The babies were burning next to it, we rescued them, extracted the incubator, and shifted them."

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis called the incident "heart-

breaking" and ordered a high-level probe. "The health administration has been directed to conduct a high-level inquiry," he said in a statement, adding that strict action will be taken against those found culpable. He announced ex gratia of ₹5 lakh to the family of each deceased infant.

Health Minister Prakash Abitkar, who rushed to Amravati, flagged "grave" irregularities at the fire-hit hospital and said a seven-member panel would probe the blaze and submit its report within eight days.

"The situation here is horrific and unfortunate. Whatever irregularities were there at the hospital were grave ones," he told presspersons.

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Monsoon Session ends as Oppn. steps up attack

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Monsoon Session of the State Legislature ended abruptly on Monday, two days ahead of schedule, after the BJP-JD(S) combine announced plans to step up its protest demanding the resignation of Minister B. Nagendra.

The 10-day session, the first after D.K. Shivakumar became the Chief Minister, was scheduled to transact business on Tuesday and Thursday too. However, both the Houses were adjourned *sine die* on Monday evening.

The Opposition BJP and JD(S) had mounted a sustained challenge to the Congress government since the beginning of the session by holding continuous protests inside and outside the House, demanding the resignation of Minister B. Nagendra, who has been chargesheeted in the alleged embezzlement of funds meant for the wel-



BJP and JD(S) leaders meeting Governor Thaaarchand Gehlot in Bengaluru on Monday.

fare of ST communities. However, the government maintained that there was no need for Mr. Nagendra to quit, as none of the inquiries against him had found him guilty.

However, on Monday, the Opposition BJP stepped up its attack by attempting to lay siege to the Vidhana Soudha. Though the police foiled the bid by taking the protesters into custody, the BJP and JD(S) later announced that they would launch a night-long dharna in the legislature from Monday night. Hours later, the government expedited legislative business

by taking up additional agenda items and securing approval for 10 Bills amid vociferous protests by Opposition members. This included the Appropriation Bill, which would normally have been taken up on the last day of the session. The government also made a statement in the legislature on the drought gripping the State. During the eight-day session, a total of 16 Bills were passed.

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RELATED REPORTS ON
» PAGE 4

State draft rolls have 4.46 cr. voters; 1.07 cr. names removed

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

With the removal of over 1.07 crore names, Karnataka's electorate shrunk to 4.46 crore voters when the draft electoral rolls were published on Monday as part of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

An overwhelming number of the missing names were marked 'Absent, Shifted, Duplicate, Dead, and Others' (ASDDO).

Announcing the figures at the end of the enumeration phase, Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) V. Anbu Kumar said the electorate comprised over 2.22 crore males, 2.24 crore females, and 2,871 others.

Voters can check their names on the CEO's official website.

With the enumeration phase ending, voters are likely to face the same problems they encountered with the ASDDO list.

Just as people remained unaware that their names were on the ASDDO list until 12 days before the enumeration phase ended, they now have no way of knowing whether they will receive a notice until one is actually served.

"We only have numbers on how many people will receive notices, and the names will not be known until the notice is generated," the CEO said.

Seven-day window

However, the entire process — from an ERO generating a notice to it being served — is to be completed within just seven days.

This could become a major hurdle, especially for voters living in another district or city while re-

Breaking down draft deletions in Telangana SIR

Driven by a deletion rate of 35% or more in Hyderabad and adjoining urban areas, Telangana has registered the highest deletion rate — 21.7% — in the enumeration phase of the SIR process in the country. In contrast to northern States though, the gender ratio in the draft rolls improved from 1,018 to 1,028. » PAGE 7

maining registered in their native constituency, as the voter must attend the hearing in person.

There is, so far, no online option to check whether a person is likely to receive a notice.

The CEO reiterated that names will be known only after a notice is generated.

Highest deletions

While Bengaluru has already seen the highest deletions, with more than 46.88 lakh voters on the ASDDO list out of an electorate of over 1.03 crore, existing electors who made it to the draft rolls will continue to face further hurdles.

More than 24.06 lakh voters in the city will receive notices over logical discrepancies or for returning their enumeration forms without 2002 electoral roll details, leaving them unmapped.

Bengaluru Urban, which has seven constituencies, has 9.46 lakh voters who are either unmapped or flagged for logical discrepancies.

RELATED REPORT ON
» PAGE 2

Braving the weather



Rough outing: Fishing boats seen off the Visakhapatnam coast on Monday, despite the India Meteorological Department's advisory against venturing into the sea until Tuesday as conditions along the north Andhra Pradesh coast are expected to stay rough to very rough. K.R. DEEPAK

CRPF sub-inspector injured, two houses torched in clash between Manipur groups

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

A Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) sub-inspector was injured and at least two houses were torched after violence erupted between two groups in Manipur on Monday.

Officials in Imphal said unknown miscreants burnt a house in the Taphou Kuki village in the Kuki-dominated Kangpokpi district in the early hours. Soon after, another house was torched at Taphou Naga village in the adjoining Naga-dominated Senapati district.

As tension mounted, two groups exchanged fire after 9 a.m. The CRPF sub-inspector was caught in the



Burning streets: A road blocked by local people amid reports of violence in Senapati, Manipur, on Monday. ANI

crossfire and got shot. He was later admitted to a local hospital.

Local people in Senapati blocked National Highway no. 2, also known as the Imphal-Dimapur (Nagaland) road, for a few hours

after the violence. Following the incidents, the security forces heightened alert along the highway and in vulnerable villages in the two districts.

The Taphou Kuki village authority condemned the

"highly deplorable, inhuman, and unacceptable" arson attack, appealing to individuals and groups to refrain from violence, destruction of property, and any actions that may further escalate tension and suffering among the people.

Probe sought

"We urge the district administration, police, and other competent authorities to take immediate and appropriate action to investigate the incident, identify those responsible, and ensure that justice is delivered in accordance with the law," the village authority said in a statement.

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T.N. drops Parandur airport project; new sites 'identified'



The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday announced his government's decision to drop the proposed airport project in Parandur and identify alternative sites for a second airport in Chennai.

Making a *suo motu* statement in the Assembly, he said a new terminal, Terminal 5, would be developed in the north-western part of the Chennai airport in collaboration with the Airports Authority of India (AAI), along with an approach road and a flyover.

The main Opposition DMK sought to speak on the issue, but Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar said he would not allow a debate on an announcement made under Rule 110 of the Assembly. Former Finance Minister Thangam Thennarasu said he was not seeking a debate but wanted to clarify. DMK members then walked out after the Speaker stood his ground.

'Experts consulted'

The Chief Minister said he had consulted experts on the creation of a new airport and that a few alternative sites had been identified that would cause minimal damage to farmland and human settle-

Vijay says the Chennai airport currently handles 30 million passengers a year

ments. "The site will be finalised after studying the technical feasibility and consulting the departments concerned," he said, recalling his visit to Parandur in 2025 to express solidarity with protesting farmers and protesting at Vikravandi opposing the project.

Mr. Vijay said he was fully aware of the role of airports in industrial development but maintained that an airport should not be built at Parandur as it would affect vast tracts of farmland and human settlements. "But the previous government tried to create a new airport at the cost of farmers, their lands and human settlements," he said. He said the Chennai airport currently handled 30 million passengers a year and that its capacity would increase to 35 million once Terminal 3 was completed. "After the completion of Terminal 5, the passenger capacity will increase to 55 million a year. It will improve the services and transport facilities until a new airport is completed," he said.

Onus on individuals to save votes

Unlike the enumeration phase, when Booth Level Officers were instructed to hand over enumeration forms to voters and a family member above the age of 18 could fill them out on the voter's behalf, BLOs, during the next stage, can serve notices on anyone available at the address

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

With Karnataka's draft electoral rolls published on Monday, as part of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), the burden of saving one's vote is now placed squarely on the voter. With the removal of over 1.07 crore names, Karnataka's electorate has now shrunk to 4.46 crore voters.

Unlike the enumeration phase, when Booth Level Officers (BLOs) were instructed to hand over enumeration forms to voters and a family member above the age of 18 could fill them out on the voter's behalf, BLOs, during the next stage, can serve notices on anyone available at the address.

The notice will also carry a QR code to submit one of the 11 documents online, but the voter alone must appear for the hearing.

This could pose challenges for sections of voters such as senior citizens, single mothers, women in general, labourers and persons with disabilities, among others.

For instance, within Greater Bengaluru Authority (GBA) limits alone, 40,307 voters are above



V. Anbu Kumar, Karnataka CEO, addressing a press conference in Bengaluru on Monday. K. MURALI KUMAR

DRAFT ROLLS

the age of 85, while 829 are above 100. More than 21,400 voters are persons with disabilities.

People may also face problems, since, after rationalisation of polling stations, part numbers or polling stations may have shifted.

Many in the same family are found to be in different polling stations.

Following the enumeration phase, the number of polling stations across Karnataka increased after rationalisation.

Each polling station will now have up to and not more than 1,200 voters, and where a polling station had more voters, they

Notice and appeal

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

As many as 43.81 lakh notices will be served to voters with logical discrepancies or those who could not be mapped.

Notices may be issued if a complaint is filed against a voter or if the ERO has reason to suspect a voter is

were shifted to another polling station within a two-kilometre radius, Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) V. Anbu Kumar said.

This has resulted in the addition of 1,873 polling stations across the State.

Special campaign

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The CEO said a special campaign will be conducted in areas reporting high ASDDO numbers, where voters will be assisted in filling Form 6. The dates for the campaign are yet to be announced.

ineligible. Such notices are discretionary, with the ERO vested with powers to decide.

If aggrieved by an ERO's decision, a voter can appeal to the DEO/DC within 15 days. If the response remains unsatisfactory, the voter can appeal to the CEO within 30 days of the first appeal.

Voters face website glitches

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

While the draft electoral rolls were published at 12 p.m. on Monday, people

Roll call

Age-wise electors as per draft rolls

Age group	Male	Female	Third gender	Total
18-19	1,98,422	1,71,910	9	3,70,341
20-29	43,87,276	39,99,875	729	83,87,880
30-39	51,11,459	50,47,065	1,115	1,01,59,639
40-49	46,37,353	47,11,829	594	93,49,776
50-59	37,22,651	38,58,043	248	75,80,942
60-69	23,82,881	26,81,308	105	50,64,294
70-79	12,91,633	14,40,787	52	27,32,472
80-89	3,71,152	4,72,874	18	8,44,044
90+	56,241	89,978	1	1,46,220

General and service electors

Particulars	Male	Female	Others	Total
General	2,21,59,240	2,24,73,864	2,871	4,46,35,975
Service	42,487	1,689	0	44,176
Total	2,22,01,727	2,24,75,553	2,871	4,46,80,151

Polling station rationalisation

Description	Urban	Rural	Total
Pre-SIR polling stations as on June 16	21,520	37,530	59,050
Draft roll polling stations as on August 24	21,862	39,061	60,923
Increase in polling stations	342	1,531	1,873

Probe stayed against Bidadi farmers who protested with brooms opposing survey

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The High Court of Karnataka on Monday stayed all further investigation into a criminal case registered against six farmers on the allegation of attempt to murder for protesting with brooms and preventing officials of a government survey team from entering their agricultural lands for the contentious Greater Bengaluru Integrated Township Project in Bidadi.

Justice M. Nagaprasanna passed the interim order on the petition filed by H.R. Nagaraja and others.

Noticing that the complaint was lodged by a driver of a privately rented car, which was hired by the officials, and not by any of the officials who were assaulted when they went for

the survey, the court said, "The very registration of the crime is shrouded with suspicion."

The police had registered the case under Sections 109(1) and 74 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

Earlier, senior advocate D.R. Ravishankar, appearing for the petitioners, pointed out that the farmers were merely protesting with brooms in their hands against the officials.

Pointing out that the State government itself had issued a public statement that land acquisition would not be undertaken without obtaining consent from the farmers, Mr. Ravishankar said that petitioner-farmers wish to continue farming on their ancestral lands and argued that their proximity to Bengaluru city should not be grounds for compulsory acquisition.



A file photo of Bidadi farmers protesting with brooms against government officials attempting to survey their agricultural land.

INBRIEF

Gang held for killing of man

The Madiwala police have arrested six people in connection with the murder of a medical shop owner, Suhail. The accused have been identified as Adil, a Bandepalya rowdy-sheeter and his associates – Yasin, Abbas, Afivullah, Shaan, and Syed Farhan. The deceased was allegedly intercepted by an armed gang at Madiwala traffic signal and hacked to death in full public view on Saturday night. According to the police, the murder was allegedly carried out as an act of revenge for the killing of Adil's friend Shabbir in January. The police suspect that Suhail had allegedly provided financial assistance for Shabbir's murder and that his brothers were also involved in the killing. Angered by this, Adil allegedly planned Suhail's murder in retaliation. Investigators also suspect that Suhail had threatened that he would assault Adil before the latter could retaliate against him. After killing Suhail, the accused had reportedly planned to flee to Mumbai, but were tracked down.

On-duty civic marshal attacked

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Amruthahalli police are on the lookout for a man who allegedly assaulted a civic marshal of the Bengaluru North City Corporation for questioning him about throwing garbage on a public road.

The incident reportedly took place on Sunday morning near Amruthahalli Lake, where marshal Venkatesh R., a resident of Snehanagar and posted in the Byatarayanapura Ward, was on duty.

According to the complaint, Mr. Venkatesh noticed Vijay Kumar, a resi-

dent of Amruthanagar, throwing garbage on the road. When Mr. Venkatesh questioned him about littering in a public place, Vijay Kumar allegedly became angry, abused him and slapped him. The accused allegedly tore Mr. Venkatesh's uniform and obstructed him from carrying out his official duties.

Following the incident, Mr. Venkatesh lodged a complaint at the Amruthahalli Police Station on the instructions of Bengaluru North City Corporation Commissioner Pommala Sunil Kumar. The police have registered an FIR and launched a probe. The civic

body has appealed to citizens to cooperate with marshals and sanitation workers involved in maintaining cleanliness and public health.

The corporation also urged residents not to dump garbage on roads, footpaths or other public places. Residents have been advised to hand over household waste to garbage collection vehicles when they arrive at the scheduled time.

If the garbage collection vehicle does not arrive on time, citizens can lodge a complaint by calling the 1533 civic helpline, the corporation said.

Teen rescued from building terrace

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A 15-year-old boy in severe emotional distress was rescued by the Bengaluru police after he attempted to jump from the terrace of a five-storey building in Akshayanagar on Saturday night.

The incident occurred at 8.48 p.m. at 1st Cross, Elenahalli, within the limits of the Hulimavu Police Station. The boy's brother alerted the Namma-112 emergency helpline after noticing that he was in distress and had gone to the terrace.

Namma-112 personnel

The boy's brother alerted Namma-112 emergency helpline after noticing he was in distress and had gone to the terrace

immediately alerted Satish Kumar, ASI, and police constable Shabeer Mammadur, who were patrolling in Hoysala-215 of the Begur Police Station. The policemen reached the spot within eight minutes.

Social media trouble

According to the police, the boy had reportedly become emotionally distressed over an issue relat-

ed to Instagram. When his uncle tried to console him, he ran away and climbed to the terrace, where he threatened to jump.

The policemen carefully approached him and intervened at the right moment, preventing him from taking the extreme step. They brought him to safety, counselled, and reassured him.

(If you are in distress or having suicidal tendencies, please reach out to these helplines: TeleMANAS at 1-8008914416/ 14416, NIM-HANS at 08026685948, 9480829670 or SAHAJ at 080 25497777, +91-988644075)

Study: Availability of predictable food through garbage, intentional feeding linked to India's street-dog population

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A new study on the Indian street dog states that "food subsidies" – availability of abundant, predictable food through garbage and intentional feeding – have an impact on their population in the country's urban ecosystems.

The study, titled "The Indian street dog crisis and multi-species coexistence in tropical urban futures", conducted by Nishant Kumar, a DBT/Wellcome Trust India Alliance Fellow at the National Centre for Biological Sciences (NCBS), said that abundant and predictable food through garbage and the intentional feeding provided to free-ranging dogs influences their population.

New perspective

NCBS said that while India's street-dog crisis is often framed as a problem of animal population control, Mr. Kumar's study published in *Nature Cities* offers a new perspective as he argues that the driver lies in how Indian cities provide free-ranging dogs with



It's a dog's life: The National Centre for Biological Sciences says that dogs have historically played a role in urban ecosystems by scavenging human waste. FILE PHOTO

abundant and predictable food through garbage and intentional feeding.

"These food subsidies influence not just dog numbers, but where dogs congregate, how they move, reproduce and defend territories, and where conflicts with people are likely to occur," NCBS said.

It added that dogs have historically played a role in urban ecosystems by scavenging human waste.

Rapid urbanisation

"Rapid urbanisation, ho-

wever, has transformed this relationship. Growing quantities of food waste, concentrated feeding sites, and changing urban infrastructure now create resource-rich environments for free-ranging dogs, while restricting their movement through roads, buildings, and other built structures," it added.

Mr. Kumar further said that interventions such as sterilisation, vaccination, removal or fencing alone may have limited success without a simultaneous addressal of the demographic

driver, which is food subsidies.

"The consequences extend beyond dog-human conflict. Free-ranging dogs can prey on wildlife, compete with native scavengers and mesopredators, and transmit pathogens to wild carnivores. India also bears a substantial burden of dog bites and rabies, and dog counts and bite statistics reveal little about the ecological processes sustaining these populations," he said.

The study added that sterilisation, shelters, fencing or removals cannot succeed when urban landscapes provide food subsidies to animals without corresponding responsibility.

The study calls for a shift from reactive dog control to multispecies coexistence and says that this would require public health, veterinary services, waste management, urban planning, and conservation agencies to work together, supported by long-term data on dog populations, movement, reproduction, mortality, and behaviour.

International conference organised by RUAS

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A three-day International Conference on Advances in Materials Science and Technology (ICAMST) 2026 was organised by M.S. Ramaiah University of Applied Sciences recently in Bengaluru.

A. Velumani, founder of Thyrocare and AVM Labs and AVM Smiles inaugurat-

ed the conference along with K.K. Raina, Vice-Chancellor of RUAS and Ashok Rao, Registrar. ICAMST 2026 focused on interdisciplinary advances made in material science and their applications across fields. The release of the Abstract Book symbolised the collective intellectual contribution of researchers and participants in ICAMST 2026.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public are hereby notified that my client intends to purchase the **SCHEDULED PROPERTY** from its Owners **Mrs. Deepika Battipati wife of Mr. Ramesh Babu K.V and 5 others.**

Persons/banks/societies/firm or any other body having any right, title, interest, claim or charge over the schedule mentioned property or any part thereof is hereby notified to lodge their objections/claims if any, in writing with documentary evidence regarding their manner of right, title, interest, claim or charge, within 10 days from the date of this publication to the office of undersigned, after which period my client shall proceed to purchase the schedule mentioned property on the basis that there are no objections/claims of whatsoever nature with regard to the schedule mentioned property.

SCHEDULE

All that piece and parcel of the Vacant Plot bearing No. 2679/44, formed out of the Converted Land bearing Sy. No. 25/3, BBMP Katha No.2875/2679/44, conversion orders No. B. Dis. A.L.N.S.R.(S)93/1994/95, dated 03/01/1995, situated at **Kasavanahalli Village, Varthur Hobli, Bangalore East Taluk,** measuring East to West 50 feet, And North to South 80 feet. In all measuring 4000 Sq. Feet, and bounded on the:

East by : Plot bearing No.51
West by : 4th Road
North by : Plot bearing No.43
South by : Plot bearing No. 45

LEGAL & LEGAL ADVOCATES,
No.32, Ground Floor, Rukman's Brindavanam, 1st Cross, 1st Main, Subramani Layout, Ramamurthy Nagar, Vijayapura, Bengaluru-560016
Mob: 9900111844, 7406234888.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that my client **Mr. N.M. MADHUPPA son of N.S. Muthanna** is intending to purchase the immovable property described in the Schedule hereunder from its present owner i.e., **Mr Suresh son of Late Mr. Narayanappa.** Any person's, financial institutions Etc having any claims /right/interest/ claims/Demands/lien/ charge / mortgage lease/ Tenancy, Easementary /inheritance/ litigation/ attachment or any acquisition proceedings or any other encumbrance whatsoever, in respect of the Scheduled Property may file their objections / claims with the undermentioned address with documentary evidence within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. If no claims/objections are received within the stipulated period as mentioned supra, it will be presumed that there is no claims/objections in respect of the Scheduled Property and my client will be proceeding to purchase the same.

SCHEDULED PROPERTIES

Item No. 1 : All that piece and parcel of Agricultural land in **New Sy.No.76/3,** measuring 01 acre 30 guntas, situated at **Govindahalli Village, Madure Hobli, Doddaballapura Taluk,** Bangalore Rural District, Bangalore and bounded on : East By : Govindaraju's Land, West By : Rajanna's Land, North By : Rajanna's Land & South By : Sanjeevappa's Land.

Item No. 2 : All that piece and parcel of Agricultural land in **Sy.No.76/5,** measuring 10 guntas, situated at **Situated at Govindahalli Village Madure Hobli, Doddaballapura Taluk,** Bangalore Rural District, Bangalore and bounded on : East By : Gopalappa's Land, West By : Jayamma's Land, North By : Thimmanna's Land & South By : Suresh's Land.

Lakshmi Law Associates Advocates and Consultants
Having office at No.2232, 2nd Floor, New Town Bangalore, Near BMTC Bus Stand, 16th Main Sector-8, Yalahanka new Town Bangalore 560 064.
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PERSONAL	PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME	CHANGE OF NAME
I, MOHAMED Gulrez, S/o Mohammed Ishag, R/a No.8/1, 5th B Cross, KHE Road, P K Palace, Kaverinagar, RT Nagar Post, Bangalore - 560032 have changed my name to Mohammed Gulrez vide affidavit dt: 11.07.2026 sworn before Notary N.Nagappa, B'luu.	I, MAHABOOB B.I. W/o Mohammed Shouse, R/a No.18, 15th Cross, Bhuvaneshwari Nagar, Bengaluru - 560032 have changed my name to MahabooB B vide affidavit dt: 22.08.2026 before Notary Leela, Bluru
I, SYEDA Samrin Banu, W/o Syed Wasim, r/at No.E-94/1, Banngerghatta Road, Near Anganavadi, Pilliganahalli, Guttigere, Bangalore 560083 have changed my name as Samrin Banu Mehaboob Basha vide affidavit dt: 05.08.2026 sworn before Notary B.V.Nagabhushana, Bluru	I, SYED Waseem, S/o Syed Noor r/at No.E-94/1, Banngerghatta Road, Near Anganavadi, Pilliganahalli, Guttigere, Bangalore 560083 have changed my name as Shakeel Ahmed vide affidavit dt: 03.08.2026 sworn before Notary B.V.Nagabhushana, Bluru
I, RAZIA Sultana Nazeer Ahmed, W/o Shakeel Ahmed, r/at No.6/1, 1st Floor, Wood Street, Ashoknagar, Bangalore 560025 have changed my name as Razia Sultana vide affidavit dt: 03.08.2026 sworn before Notary Meer Hassan, Bluru	I, SIRAJUDDIN Shakeel Ahmed, S/o. Sirajuddin Sab, r/at No.6/1, 1st Floor, Wood Street, Ashoknagar, Bangalore 560025 have changed my name as Shakeel Ahmed vide affidavit dt: 03.08.2026 sworn before Notary Meer Hassan, Bluru
I, KM Jyoti W/o Santosh Kumar Pandey (Army No JC-341041X) VTC: Pure Garibdas, PO Garwara, District, Pratapgarh, Uttar Pradesh- 230502. Heresby declare that My correct name is KM Jyoti and Jyoti Pandey and actual date of birth is 07-07-1988 and not 07-07-1984 vide affidavit dated 22-08-2026, before Notary Y.R. Chandrashekar, Bangalore-560032	NOTICE Petitioner filed M.V.O.R.No.162/2024, for compensation against both of you and your Insurance Company for the injuries sustained by me in a Bolero Car bearing No.KA-07-B-5875, accident. The said M.V.O.R is posted to 18-09-2026, for your appearance in the above Hon'ble Court. Hence, you are directed by the Hon'ble Court to appear in the above court on 18-09-2026, at 10-30 am, in person or through Advocate, and file your objections if any otherwise, matter will be decided ex-parte. // BY COURT ORDER // T.MALLIKARJUNA, B.C.M., B.L., Advocate, Kadapa, A.P.
RENTAL	TO-LET WAREHOUSE/ godown Ban- nerghatta 12000 sq/f 6364751676

Govt. amends 2 laws to clear legal hurdles for tunnel road project

The move, made a day after Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani met Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar, has drawn strong condemnation from petitioners arguing that this amounted to ‘regularising violations in retrospect’

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A day after Gautam Adani, chairman, Adani Group, which has emerged as the lowest bidder in Bengaluru’s North-South Twin Tunnel project, met Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar at his residence, the State government got Bills amending two laws passed in both Houses of the State legislature on Monday to clear legal hurdles for the project.

Three Public Interest Litigations (PILs) in the High Court challenging the tunnel road project had contended that it was in violation of these two laws. The move has drawn strong condemnation from the petitioners arguing that this amounted to “regularising violations in retrospect”.

On Monday, the legislature passed the Bengaluru Metropolitan Land Transport Authority (Amendment) Bill, 2026, which gives deemed approval for all projects initiated after the commencement of the BMLTA Act, 2022, and before the notification of the BMLTA Rules, 2026, on July 3. A batch of three PILs in the High Court had contended that as per Section 19 of the BMLTA Act, 2022, the authority had to approve all major urban mobility projects in Bengaluru and the tunnel road project did not have this approval. Now, as per the amendment Bill, the project will be “deemed approved”.



Three PILs contended that as per Section 19 of the BMLTA Act, 2022, the authority had to approve all major urban mobility projects and the tunnel road project did not have this approval. FILE PHOTO

Satya Arikutharam, an independent urban mobility expert, said that the BMLTA Act, 2022, was passed in 2023, but the authority was not constituted for years. “When citizens challenged the tunnel road project for not being approved by the BMLTA, as per Section 19 of the BMLTA Act, 2022, the State government notified the BMLTA Rules, 2026, on July 3, which comprised Rule 24 that gave deemed approval to projects prior to the notification of the rules. There are two PILs challenging the constitutionality of Rule 24, apart from the three PILs challenging tunnel roads. Fearing the court may strike down Rule 24, the government has now amended

The HC directs that any contract for the tunnel road project will be subject to the outcome of the three PILs

the Act itself to accord approval for all the unscientific car-centric projects,” Mr. Arikutharam alleged. Likewise, the Karnataka Government Parks (Preservation) (Amendment) Bill, 2026, which allows alienation of 5% of parks and garden lands for public purposes, was also passed. The tunnel road project will need one acre of Lalbagh land, while six acres will be used temporarily for construction. The Karnataka Government Parks (Preservation) Act, 1975,

Tunnel troubles

Contentions about statutory non-compliance of tunnel road project in 3 PILs and the status at present	
Contention: Violation of Bengaluru Metropolitan Transport Authority Act, 2022, as tunnel road project was not approved by BMLTA as per Section 19 of the Act	Status: Section 19 of the Act amended for the projects taken up between 2023, when BMLTA Act came into force, and BMLTA Rules, 2026, was notified, to be “deemed approved”
Contention: Project to take up 6 acres of Lalbagh land temporarily during construction and 1 acre permanently, in violation of Section 5 of The Karnataka Government Parks (Preservation) Act, 1975	Status: Section 5 of the Act amended allowing 5% of the park or garden lands to be alienated by means of sale, lease, gift, exchange, mortgage for “public purposes”
Contention: Project neither part of the Revised Master Plan - 2015 nor planned as a part of the master plan preparation process, violating Karnataka Town and Country Planning Act, 1961	Status: The Revised Master Plan - 2015, in force in the city, neither includes tunnel road project nor planned as part of the exercise of drawing up RMP-2041
Contention: No scrutiny of the project by Bengaluru Metropolitan Planning Committee (BMPC) violating Article 243ZE of the Constitution	Status: BMPC, constituted in 2014, lapsed with the term of the then State govt. in 2018

doesn’t allow this and the three PILs flagged the tunnel road as violating this law by taking over the Lalbagh land.

N.S. Mukunda, one of the petitioners in the High Court against the tunnel road project, condemned the amendments, which he described as “an attempt to make some of their grounds infructuous in retrospect”. He said this was a “deeply undemocratic move and they will fight it in the court and also petition the Governor appealing him to not give them (the amendment Bills) his assent”.

However, the three PILs have flagged other statutory non-compliances apart from these two laws, such

as no approval from the Bengaluru Metropolitan Planning Committee (BMPC), and the project not being part of the Revised Master Plan - 2015.

The High Court on July 16, 2026, directed that any contract for the tunnel road project will be subject to the outcome of the three PILs challenging the project. The court also said the government should inform the contractors in writing that the contract would be subject to the final outcome of the petitions. The next hearing was scheduled for August 20, but did not come up for hearing that day.

RELATED REPORT ON
» **PAGE 4**

Ramalinga Reddy seeks review of proposed annual ₹25,000 residential parking fee

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Forest, Ecology, and Environment Minister Ramalinga Reddy has urged Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar to comprehensively review the proposed annual fee of ₹15,000-₹25,000 for residential parking permits in Bengaluru.

Mr. Reddy shared his letter to the Chief Minister on

social media and said that while curbing illegal and long-term street parking was crucial to easing traffic congestion, many middle-class residents in older layouts and smaller houses lacked internal parking facilities. He said the additional annual fee could place a significant financial burden on citizens amid the rising cost of living.

Although the new draft



Ramalinga Reddy

of the Greater Bengaluru Authority’s parking rules

has proposed a comprehensive overhaul of the parking system in the city, which could help ease congestion, the residential parking permit rule drew substantial backlash.

Mr. Reddy pointed out the rising cost of essential commodities in recent times and said that the parking fee could further add to the burden on citizens. He particularly point-

ed out that middle-class families living in rented places and apartment complexes would face hurdles.

Mr. Reddy said he had urged the Chief Minister to consult Bengaluru MLAs, resident welfare associations, and other stakeholders to arrive at a balanced solution, including necessary exemptions for locals.

☀️🌧️

Timings

BENGALURU

TUESDAY, AUG. 25

☀️ RISE 06:08

🌙 SET 18:35

☀️ RISE 16:43

🌙 SET 03:30

WEDNESDAY, AUG. 26

☀️ RISE 06:08

🌙 SET 18:34

☀️ RISE 17:25

🌙 SET 04:22

THURSDAY, AUG. 27

☀️ RISE 06:08

🌙 SET 18:34

☀️ RISE 18:05

🌙 SET 05:14

Yellow Line services briefly disrupted

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Train services on Namma Metro’s Yellow Line were briefly disrupted on Monday after a train, operating from Bommasandra towards R.V. Road, developed a technical issue during service.

According to BMRC, the affected train was terminated at the Beratena Agrahara Metro Station at 5.14 p.m. to ensure smooth operations. The train was subsequently withdrawn from service and was taken up for technical examination.

The issue led to a brief disruption of train services on the Yellow Line, which connects Bommasandra with R.V. Road. BMRC said services were subsequently normalised.

Civic authorities will start cleaning vacant plots from August 27: KBG

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

With the deadline for clearing vacant sites having ended on August 22, Greater Bengaluru Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda directed civic officials to identify vacant plots requiring cleaning, serve notices to owners, and take up the cleaning work where owners fail to comply.

Property tax

The costs will be recovered by adding it to the property tax. It can vary between ₹25,900 for a 20x30 plot to ₹1,74,700 for a 50x80 plot. The drive will begin from August 27 and will be intensified from August 31.

The Minister said only around 20% of owners had complied with the dea-

Clearing bill

Site Dimension	For vacant site without compound wall	For vacant site with compound wall	Waste/debris transportation charges
20x30 = 600 sq. ft.	₹6,700	₹7,700	₹19,200
30x40 = 1,200 sq. ft.	₹13,400	₹14,400	₹38,400
30x50 = 1,500 sq. ft.	₹16,750	₹17,750	₹48,000
40x60 = 2,400 sq. ft.	₹26,800	₹27,800	₹76,800
50x80 = 4,000 sq. ft.	₹46,700	₹47,700	₹1,28,000

In case the site dimensions/area exceed the above limit, expenditure proportionate to the site area will be recovered

dline. “Cleaning of vacant plots cannot be left to chance. Wherever the civic body has to undertake the work, the cost should subsequently be recovered through the property tax,” Mr. Byre Gowda said.

Members of the public

can also flag empty sites that are not cleaned. Mr. Byre Gowda directed officials to develop a feature on the GBA’s ‘Clean It’ app to allow citizens to report vacant plots that have not been cleaned.

Civic officials have been

Apartment federation welcomes new law

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Bangalore Apartments’ Federation has welcomed the enactment of the Karnataka Apartment Ownership and Management Act (KAOMA) 2026. The new law has a greater focus on “powers of residents’ associations, promoter accountability, protection of common areas, legal recognition for future development rights, building safety and redevelopment”, the federation said. “KAOMA, 2026, is a significant improvement compared to the 1972 legal framework and has the potential to become one of India’s strongest apartment governance laws. Effective implementation will now be the key priority,” BAF president Satish Mallya said on Monday.

The BAF said the new law ensures that the promoter continues to be accountable even after handover of the flats. “Even after the management is transferred to the association, promoter obligations under the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016, will continue. It also specifies that promoters cannot retain control over common areas after management is transferred,” BAF said.

“The Act provides a stronger mechanism for transferring the management and administration of apartments to associations. However, management and ownership rights must move together. Statutory and deemed conveyance of land and common-area rights require a clear, time-bound, and enforceable mechanism,” said BAF general secretary K. Aun Kumar.

Promoters must facilitate the formation and registration of an association within three months after a majority of apartments are allotted. If they fail to do so, the competent authority can intervene, as per the new Act.

“The concept of one statutory association for each apartment project will bring greater structure to apartment governance. Recognising a registered association as a body corporate, with perpetual succession and the legal capacity to sue and be sued in its own name, is an important step forward,” said Sujatha G., policy lead, BAF.

‘Only around 20% of owners had complied with the deadline’

asked to be prepared to undertake the cleaning drive across the city.

Documentation

The Minister directed officials to make before-and-after video documentation with mandatory geo-location for every vacant plot cleaned by civic authorities.

He also said that waste and debris generated during the cleaning process are not to be dumped along roadsides or on other vacant land and are to be sent to designated disposal locations.

The entire operation must be recorded end-to-end on the ‘Clean It’ software, he added.

Food licence of Amazon, two others suspended over sale of Datura

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Karnataka Food Safety and Drug Administration has suspended the food licences of Amazon, Swiggy Instamart, and BigBasket until further orders after toxic Datura fruits and seeds were found being sold online as food products.

According to an order issued by Food Safety Commissioner K. Srinivas, the department has also directed the three platforms to immediately remove listings and advertisements for Datura, also known as Dhatura, and stop selling or distributing the products for human consumption.

The action followed inspections by food safety officials, who found Datura fruits and seeds being stored and offered for sale through e-commerce platforms using Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) registration or licence numbers.

Officials said Datura is poisonous and that its sale or distribution as a food product poses a serious public health risk.

Warehouses

During inspections, officials found packets of Datura fruits and seeds carrying food registration numbers. The products were also found stored in a warehouse and listed for sale or distribution through online platforms.

The department said that collecting, selling or distributing Datura fruits or seeds as food was unlawful given their poisonous nature. The action has been initiated under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006, and the Food Safety and Standards Rules, 2011.

Explanation sought

Representatives of the three companies appeared before the adjudicating authority on Monday, according to the Commissioner’s order.

Amazon did not submit a response to the notice, while Swiggy Instamart sought more time to sub-

The action followed inspections by food safety officials, who found Datura fruit being stored and offered for sale.

mit documents detailing the action it had taken after receiving the department’s notice.

BigBasket told the authority that it had stopped selling Datura and changed the manner in which the product would be sold. It also said that the labelling would be changed to clearly state that the product was “not for human consumption”.

The department, however, found the responses unsatisfactory, citing the poisonous nature of Datura and the potential risk to public health.

The action has also been extended to suppliers and sellers who provided Datura products to the e-commerce platforms.

Food safety authorities have ordered the suspension of their food licences and registrations under the applicable food safety laws. The department has also directed the relevant State or Central licensing authorities to initiate action to cancel the registrations of the organisations or vendors concerned, subject to due legal process. The department said separate orders would be issued after compliance reports are received and the parties concerned are given an opportunity to present their arguments.

The platforms and food businesses have been directed not to sell, distribute, advertise or display Datura fruits or seeds as food or for human consumption in future. Failure to comply could invite further action under the applicable laws.

APPOINTMENT

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CM YK A BG-BGE

Seasonal influenza: Karnataka boosts preparedness

Rise in cases part of usual seasonal pattern; do not panic: Health Dept.

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Karnataka Health Department has stepped up surveillance and preparedness measures for seasonal influenza, including H1N1, with the State recording 4,212 laboratory-confirmed cases this year across 32 districts till August 22.

The department said the rise in cases being reported during the monsoon was part of the usual seasonal pattern and urged people not to panic. In Karnataka, influenza generally records two seasonal peaks – from January to March and July to September. Health Minister U.T. Khader chaired a review meeting on Monday with senior health officials to assess the situation and preparedness.

The State's health system has adequate infrastructure and essential medicines to handle the situation, he said.

According to surveillance data on the Integrated Health Information Platform (IHIP), Karnataka has reported 4,212 laboratory-confirmed influenza-positive cases till August 22. This compares with 4,583 cases reported in 2025 and 3,903 cases in 2024. Over 50% of the 4,212 cases reported this year are from GBA limits.

Addressing presspersons after the meeting, the Minister said it was closely monitoring the situation through strengthened surveillance of influenza-like illness (ILI) and severe acute respiratory infec-



Health Minister U.T. Khader chairing a review meeting in Bengaluru on Monday with senior health officials from the State and districts to assess the H1N1 spread situation and preparedness.

tions (SARI).

The State has designated sentinel surveillance sites under the ICMR-NCDC network for monitoring respiratory viruses. The Viral Research and Diagnostic Laboratories (VRDL) network is also being used to ensure the timely collection and testing of samples. Adequate laboratory consumables were being made available to support testing and early detection, he said.

Health facilities across the State have been instructed to maintain adequate stocks of essential supplies, including personal protective equipment, N95 masks and oseltamivir. Healthcare workers have been sensitised on the early identification of ILI and SARI cases, assessment of risk and appropriate management.

Private hospitals and healthcare facilities have also been advised to follow the State's protocols for screening, testing, and treatment of H1N1 cases. They have been asked to mandatorily report cases to the surveillance authorities through the IHIP platform.

The Minister said the department has streng-

thened infection prevention and control measures in healthcare facilities and is focusing on respiratory hygiene, cough etiquette, and hand hygiene. Public awareness campaigns are also being intensified.

The department has advised people with symptoms to visit the nearest government health facility.

People have been asked to cover their nose and mouth while coughing or sneezing, wash their hands regularly with soap and water, drink plenty of fluids and isolate themselves when symptomatic.

They have also been advised to avoid touching their eyes, nose and mouth, refrain from self-medication and avoid shaking hands or visiting crowded places when they have symptoms. Reusing napkins has also been discouraged. The Minister said seasonal influenza could be prevented and managed through early detection and timely treatment, particularly among high-risk groups.

The Health Department will issue guidelines to all schools and colleges on the management of infectious diseases, Mr. Khader said on Monday.

Over ₹8L cash found in beggar's house after her death

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

More than ₹8 lakh in cash has been found in the rented house of an elderly woman who survived by begging in Guthalu locality of Mandya, following her death on Sunday.

The deceased has been identified as Hoor-Un-Nisa, who had been living alone since the death of her unmarried sister two years ago. The two sisters had reportedly lived together for several decades and depended largely on alms for their livelihood.

After Hoor-Un-Nisa died of age-related ailments, local residents and community leaders went to the house to make arrangements for her funeral. During a search of the premises, they reportedly discovered more than 30 bags containing cash and other valuables.

They initially opened some bags and counted around ₹8 lakh in cash. Nearly 20 bags are yet to be opened and counted, raising the possibility that the total cash could be considerably higher.

The recovered money has been kept at a local mosque in Guthalu for safekeeping. The community leaders have also contacted the deceased woman's surviving relatives.

The remaining bags are expected to be opened and the cash officially counted in the presence of the relatives, officials and community representatives. A decision on the lawful handover of the money will be taken after the rightful claimant to the funds is established.

Raise proportionate quantity issue with CWMA, SC tells T.N.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court advised the Tamil Nadu government on Monday to take up its contention that it was yet to be given the "proportionate" quantity of Cauvery water due from Karnataka with the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA).

Appearing before a Bench headed by Justice Vikram Nath, senior advocate C.S. Vaidyanathan, for Tamil Nadu, submitted that the "Cauvery Water Management Authority is not giving directions to make up the proportionate quantity I (Tamil Nadu) must receive".

Then Tamil Nadu must raise the issue with the CWMA itself, Justice Nath said, adding that "here the issue was about Karnataka not giving you water at all".

"As of morning, we have got some water. It was in deficit yesterday," Mr. Vaidyanathan said.

The shortfall of water as per the *pro rata* formula was 17.414 TMC (thousand million cubic feet) as of August 23, senior advocate G.

Umapathy, for Tamil Nadu, said. "Today, they have about 78 TMC in the reservoirs," the lawyer said.

The court noted Mr. Vaidyanathan's submission that the CWMA was meeting on August 25 and the State would raise the issue before the authority. The court sought an updated report and posted the case for further hearing on August 31.

An affidavit filed by Karnataka in the apex court recently had submitted that the State was able to overcome the challenges of a distress year and worsening El Nino conditions to ensure the supply of water from its Kabinri reservoir due to large inflows following good rainfall.

"The releases from the KRS (Krishna Raja Sagara) and Kabinri reservoirs have already been reflected at the inter-State border at Biligundlu," Karnataka had maintained in the affidavit.

However, Tamil Nadu had filed an additional affidavit in the Supreme Court recently, arguing that Karnataka's release of water was "never voluntary compliance".



The shortfall of water as per the *pro rata* formula was 17.414 tmc ft, T.N. said. FILE PHOTO

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday

TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaiakal, Kerala and Mahe

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	0.6	32.7	25.8	Kurnool	2	32.0	25.2
Ahmedabad	0.2	34.3	26.7	Lucknow	3	33.9	26.4
Aizawl	40	32.0	23.5	Madurai	37.0	26.6	
Bangaluru	41.1	27.5	20.8	Mangaluru	19.5	27.4	24.1
Bhopal	42	29.3	23.0	Mumbai	9	31.7	25.0
Bhubaneswar	23	31.6	25.0	Mysuru	10	29.0	20.0
Chandigarh	31.5	32.0	24.4	New Delhi	3	32.3	27.8
Chennai	31	32.7	26.0	Patna	34.5	28.5	
Coimbatore	31	30.7	22.4	Port Blair	15	29.4	24.5
Dehradun	32.8	24.0		Prayagraj	29.6	32.2	27.0
Gangtok	0.8	22.8	18.8	Puducherry	34.5	25.5	
Goa	17	32.0	25.2	Pune	28.2	23.7	
Guwahati	0.4	34.5	26.7	Raipur	82.8	30.0	24.0
Hubbali	28.0	22.0		Ranchi	14	28.2	23.0
Hyderabad	4.4	25.8	22.9	Shillong	2	25.4	18.4
Imphal	30.7	23.5		Shirna	8	28.0	18.8
Jaipur	33.8	27.3		Thiruvananthapuram	24	31.2	23.4
Kochi	22	27.6	24.0	Tiruchirappalli	38.3	28.0	
Kohima	26.0	20.0		Vijayawada	31.2	26.9	
Kolkata	11	31.7	27.5	Visakhapatnam	3.5	31.7	26.8
Kozhikode	20	27.3	24.7				

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	8	40	57	51	108		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Leh, Ladakh
Bangaluru	24	18	12	85	98		recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 187 indicating a moderate level of pollution. In contrast, Madikeri, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 12
Bengaluru	5	8	40	12	149		
Delhi	33	41	117	259	226		
Hyderabad	12	12	34	37	57		
Kolkata	5	29	38	42	82		
Lucknow	7	20	33	41	41		
Mumbai	10	40	25	23	55		
Pune	12	16	74	29	66		
Visakhapatnam	18	59	23	34	81		

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_x: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given to the general public that my client intends to purchase the immovable properties:

ITEM NO. 1, Present Corporation number 29, Present Municipal number 29, PID Number 36-48-29, E-PID Number 4273874147, Situated at 1st Main Road Thimmenahalli Bangalore, Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike Govindarajanagar Ward Number 104, Previously Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike Ward Number 36, Earlier Bangalore City Corporation 21 Thereafter 29th Division, Old Property Number 2 Of Old Municipal Number 90, Measuring East to West 30 feet and North to South 45 feet, in all measuring 1350 sq. feet and bounded on, **East** by previously M. Muniyappa's property, now Kemparamiah's property, **West** by Previously N. Nagesh Bhat's property, now Smt. Nagamma's property **North** by Balakrishna's property **South** by : Road,

ITEM NO. 2, Present Municipal Number 28, PID Number 36-48-28, E-PID Number 4273932394, Situated at 1st Main Road Thimmenahalli Bangalore, Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike Govindarajanagar Ward Number 104, Previously Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike Ward Number 36, Earlier Bangalore City Corporation Number 21 Thereafter 29th Division, measuring East to West (30+35)/2 feet and North to south (34+39)/2 feet totally measuring 1186.25 sq. Feet And Bounded on, **East** by-property No.4, **West** by-Lakappa's property, **North** by-property No.1AND **South** by-road, (SELLER): M/s. Siddhi Leisures and Lifestyle Private Limited, a company incorporated under the Companies Act, having its registered office at No. 3, Swadeshi Tower, Rest House Road, Brigade Road, Bangalore - 560001, represented by its directors.

All persons or entities claiming any right, title, interest, lien, charge, mortgage, encumbrance, lease, tenancy, easement, maintenance right, agreement to sell, or any claim whatsoever over the Schedule Properties are required to submit their claims or objections in writing, with certified supporting documents, to the undersigned within 30 days of this publication. If no claims are received within the stipulated period, it shall be deemed that none exist, and any latent claims shall stand waived. My client will thereafter proceed with the purchase, treating the properties as free from encumbrances.

Mohammed Usman Shaikh
Advocate Almas Law Consultancy
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2nd Main, 'C' Block Gayatrinagar, Banagalore-560021
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TIRUCHIRAPPALLI DISTRICT CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LTD.,
PUDUKKOTTAI ROAD, KOTTAPATTU, TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - 620 023. E-mail: gmaavitrinchy@gmail.com
Ref. No: 16512/P&IMCR TENDER/2026-2028 **E-TENDER NOTICE** Date:19.08.2026

Trichy District Co-operative Milk Producers' Union Ltd invite tender from eligible contractors to engage hired vehicles for Milk Collection Routes(RMC), Milk Procurement Team T- Board Taxi and Liquid Nitrogen distribution vehicle in Trichy District in Trichirappalli Union for the period of (2026-2028) 2 years.

Name of the work	Contract period	Approximate Tender value (Rs. in Crores)	EMD (In Rs.)	Tender Number
Milk Collection Route Vehicles	2 years	3.72	Refer Tender Document	16512/P&IMCR TENDER/ 2026-2028
T-Board Taxi	2 years	0.36	Page No: 8	
Liquid Nitrogen Distribution Vehicle	2 years	0.18	Page No: 8	

The Tender forms can be downloaded from www.tntenders.gov.in on free of cost from the date of issue of tender notice from **28.08.2026** by **4.00 PM** onwards. The Pre-Bid meeting will be held on **07.09.2026** at **11.00 AM** in Trichirappalli District Cooperative Milk Producers' Union Meeting Hall Trichy. The EMD must be paid only through online www.tntenders.gov.in and duly filled tender forms should be submitted on or before **07.10.2026** by **4.00 PM** through online e-procurement portal www.tntenders.gov.in only. The opening of the tender technical bid form will be on **08.10.2026** by **11.00 AM**. The Commercial bid opening date will be intimated through www.tntenders.gov.in. The General Manager has power to accept, reject or cancel the tender partially or fully. All other details are enclosed with the tender form.

DRO / General Manager

Trichirappalli District Co-operative Milk Producers' Union Ltd.,

DIPR/2659/TENDER/2026

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(A Government of Tamilnadu Undertaking)
Office Address: CMDA, Tower II, 4th Floor, Gandhi Irwin Bridge Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008. E-Mail: tasmacvr2015@gmail.com

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Online Tender is invited by the Managing Director, TASMAC for "Selection of a System Operator for Deployment and Operation of Reverse Vending Machines for Collection of Post-Consumer Liquor Bottles/Containers with Incentive Mechanism in Tamil Nadu under QCBS Method".

Sl. No	Description	e-Tender Reference	Tender Floating Period	e-Tender Submission Duration	Date and time of online opening of Technical Bid
1.	Online Tender for "Selection of a System Operator for Deployment and Operation of Reverse Vending Machines for Collection of Post-Consumer Liquor Bottles/Containers with Incentive Mechanism in Tamil Nadu under QCBS Method".	R3/8849/2021 Dated 24.08.2026	31.08.2026 at 11.00 AM to 05.10.2026 upto 11.00 AM	28.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 05.10.2026 Upto 11.00 AM	05.10.2026 at 12.00 Noon

The tender related documents can be downloaded and the tender shall be submitted at <https://tntenders.gov.in/>.

Tender Inviting Authority / Managing Director

TASMAC Ltd.

DIPR/2660/Tender/2026

Government of Karnataka
DEPARTMENT OF COLLEGIATE EDUCATION
NO. 1, Unnatha Shikshana Soudha, Sheshadri Road, Bangalore - 560 001
Phone: 080 22223906, email: dce.tender2017@gamil.com

No. DCE/ITS/PUR/13/2026 (Computer No.2275885) Date : 24.08.2026

E-Tender Notification

The Director for Collegiate Education, Bangalore hereby invites bids in Two-Cover system through e-Procurement portal from eligible bidders for the following Tender. The Tender Documents with detailed terms and conditions may be obtained from the website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Tender Schedules are as below:

Tender Number	Date Floating Tender on e- Procurement Portal	Date and Time of pre-bid meeting	Last date and Time for bidding through e procurement portal
Tender No: DCE/2026-27/SE0012 "Vidyarathi Sahaya Haastha – Tender for selecting a Coaching Centre for providing Competitive Exam Coaching"	24.08.2026	27.08.2026 11.00 am	02.09.2026 05.30 pm

Sd/-

Director of Collegiate Education

Bangalore, Karnataka

DIPR/CP/2400/Zen/2026-27

IN THE COURT OF HON'BLE 2ND ADDITIONAL SENIOR CIVIL JUDGE, BENGALURU RURAL DISTRICT AT BENGALURU
O.S. No. 792 OF 2026
Between : RAJAGOPAL HEGBE, Aged about 64 years, S/o. Sri. Late K. Narayana Hegde, Residing at Flat No. D-101, Ramky Utsy, No. 1, Sreenagappa Layout, New BEL Road, Bengaluru - 560 094. Phone No: 98450 76057
Email: ca.rajhegde@gmail.com, ..Plaintiff
And : Catena Homes India Private Limited and othersDefendants
Summons to Defendants under Order V Rule 20(1A) of Civil Procedure Code.
To: 1. CATENA HOMES INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED, A Company incorporated and registered under Companies Act, 1956, having its registered office at No.45, Pally Housing Lay Out, Electronic City, Bengaluru-560032, represented by its directors & email: operations@catena.org.in & lease@catena.org.inDefendant No.1
2. Mr.KIRAN KUMAR G.N. Age: Major, Residing at Villa bearing No. RH-39, Ramky Serene Woods, Chikkaagubbi, Main Road, Chikkaagubbi Village, Bengaluru-560 077.Defendant No.2
3. Mrs.NISARGA VIJAY KUMAR, Age: Major, Wife of Mr.Kiran Kumar G.N, Residing at Villa bearing No. RH-39, Ramky Serene Woods, Chikkaagubbi Main Road, Chikkaagubbi Village, Bengaluru-560 077, nisargavi@gmail.comDefendant No.3
WHEREAS, the Plaintiff has defended the above suit against you and another for reliefs of (a) ejectment from the Plaint Schedule Property, (b) for recovery of Rs. 6,31,900/- together with current and future interest at 6% per annum on the aforesaid principal arrears of rents etc due in a sum of Rs.2,97,000/- from 23-03-2026 till the date of realization, (c) Damages in a sum of Rs.60,000/- (Rupees Sixty Thousand only) per month w.e.f. 24th March 2026 till the Defendants No.1 to 3 quit and deliver vacant, peaceful, physical possession of the Plaint Schedule Property to the Plaintiffs, (d) For an Order for an enquiry under Order 20 Rule 12 of the Code of Civil Procedure for payment of mesne profits, and (e) Costs of the suit, **You, the Defendants named above, is hereby summoned to appear in this court in person or by a pleader duly instructed and able to answer all material questions on the 30th day of September 2026 at 11.00 in the forenoon. Take notice that in default of your appearance on the date before mentioned the Petition will be proceeded with and determined in your absence.**

SCHEDULE PROPERTY
All that piece and parcel of the immovable property being Residential Villa bearing No. 39, Ramky Serene Woods, Chikka Gubbi Main Road, Chikka Gubbi Village, Bengaluru-560077, together with built-up area of 167.22 Square Meters consisting of 2 Halls, 1 Kitchen, 1 Utility, 3 Bedrooms, 3 Bathroom and Toilets, 2 Balconies, Terrace Floor Area and 1 Car Parking Slot.
Given under my hand and seal on this the 12th day of August 2026.
By order of the Court, Civil Ministerial Officer, Senior Civil Judge Court, Bengaluru Rural District.
Advocate for Plaintiff: Sd/- Manjunath T.R.
For Sri. Ganesh Bhat V.K., Advocate
#22, I Floor, Yamunabai Road, Madhavanager, Bengaluru-560 001.
E-Mail: ganeshbhaty@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

Our client Reena Prabhakar C/O Prabhakar, aged about 44 years, residing at 2nd Main Road, Brightway Layout, Subramanyapura Post Office, Uttarahalli, Bengaluru South-560061, Mob.No:9886195949, intends to purchase the property shown in the schedule from its owner K.Dundamma, C/O.Hanumantharaju.T., No.689, Kanakapura Main Road, Behind Gyan Sweekara School, Muniramaiah Colony, Talaghattapura Village, Bangalore South-560062 and their children Prudhivini.H and Gautam Gowda.H. If anyone has any ownership, share, maintenance, possession, inheritance, sale agreement, mortgage, loan, mortgage, rent, lease, court case, injunction, right, obligation or any objection on this property, he/she should come to our client or our office with appropriate documents within 10 days of the publication of this notice. In case of failure to do so, if no objection is received within the specified period, our client will consider that there is no right or objection of any third party on the said property and will be the purchaser of the Scheduled Property. Our client will not be responsible for any claim or objection filed later.

Land Scheduled Property
Bangalore South District, Kanakapura Taluk, Uyyamballi Hobli, Kotekopura Village, agricultural land (Old Survey No. 76/2) Current Survey No. 76/4 with area 3 acre and 15 gunta land To the East: Akhandappa & Mahadevaya's land, To the West:Kodihalli K.M. Shivayya's land, To the North:Land of Survey No. 75, To the South: Kodihalli K.M. Prasannaiah's land
Lawyer Office Details:
S.V SUBRAHMANYA
Opposite taluk panchayath road, NES, 3rd cross, Rainbow school building, Malavalli Town, Mandya District.571430
Mob.No:9886883763/7019448212

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY
Publication of Tender Notice No. CAO/CN/BMC/194/2026 Dated: 18-08-2026
The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India, Invites E-Tenders for the following work:

Item of work	Approx. Value
Construction of additional loop line with Electrification, Extension of minor bridges, Extension of FOB, Construction of Type.II quarters, Rest House, Platform & Development area and other allied works at Dodbale station between Yasvantpur-Tumakuru section on South Western Railway (Composite Work). (Tender Ref. No: YPRTK-DBL-ADDL-LOOPLINE-R)	Rs.15,12,42,737/-

Last date for submission of bids: **Upto 15:00 Hrs. on 11-09-2026**

For details log on: www.irops.gov.in

Deputy Chief Engineer/Construction/Works Bangalore Cantonment

PUB/400/AAF/PRB/SWR/2026-27

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[@South Western Railway - SWR](#) [@SWRIL](#) [@SWRAILWAYS](#) [@sw_railways](#)

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY
The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India, Invites E-Tenders for the following work:

Description of work	Approx. Value
(Re-Tender) Mysuru Augmentation of Mechanised Laundry from 3.5 Ton to 7 Ton / Day capacity.	Rs. 1,00,42,730.50

Last date for submission of bids for Tender: **Upto 11:00 Hrs. on 09-09-2026**

E-Tender Notice No.Y/E.29/2026-27773 Dated: 18-08-2026

Description of work	Approx. Value
1) Haranahalli (Halt) - Extension of PF No.1 to 470 meter and raising of PF to High level and provision of other passenger amenities.	Rs. 76,93,288.55
2) Upgradation of Kanivehalli and Biselehalli halts on par with NSG-6 category, in view of conversion into Block station	Rs. 22,64,756.00

Last date for submission of bids for Tender: **Upto 11:00 Hrs. on 10-09-2026**

E-Tender Notice No.Y/E.29/2026-27776 Dated: 19-08-2026

Description of work	Approx. Value
Provision/Replacement of existing energy meter with GSM based prepaid energy meter for outsiders/ temporary power supply over Mysuru Division	Rs. 22,64,756.00

Last date for submission of bids for Tender: **Upto 11:00 Hrs. on 10-09-2026**

E-Tender Notice No.Y/E.29/2026-27776 Dated: 19-08-2026

Description of work	Approx. Value
(Re-Tender) Mysuru - Construction of First-floor Building at new OPD Block and Improvements to Circulating area including compound wall of Railway Hospital at Mysuru	Rs. 75,42,820.21

Last date for submission of bids for Tender: **Upto 11:00 Hrs. on 10-09-2026**

For details log on: www.irops.gov.in

Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer General / Mysuru

PUB/393/AAF/PRB/SWR/2026-27

Download the RailOne app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.

[@South Western Railway - SWR](#) [@SWRIL](#) [@SWRAILWAYS](#) [@sw_railways](#)

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FIRST YEAR ANNIVERSARY

PAVITHRAN P
DOB: 01-12-1953 - DOD: 25-08-2025

A year has passed since you left for your heavenly abode, yet your guiding light, wisdom, and values continue to inspire and guide us every single day. The beautiful memories we shared remain our deepest sources of strength and motivation, reminding us of the love and legacy you left behind. Though your presence is no longer with us, you remain deeply cherished, remembered, and missed.

Tendly remembered by,
Spouse Mrs Sheejamani N A,
Grandchildren Devvratt and Devanshi,
Children - Arjun & Pavana,
Aswin & Jubina

REMEMBRANCE

1st YEAR REMEMBRANCE

(31.10.1981-25.08.2025)
Smt. Chethana MP
Wife of **A.Run Bharathi**
Gone from our sight, but never from our hearts.
We will be gathering to share our memories on August 25th, 2026 at
Our Home
#10, 4th Main Road, 3rd block, 3rd Stage, Basaveshwarnagar, Bangalore -560 079.
Please join us as we celebrate her life and the love she gave so freely.
Warm regards,
Family and Friends

CM YK A BG-BCE



Invisible actors

The ECI must stop filing of bulk applications for deletion of voters

The Election Commission of India (ECI)’s Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls has seen allegations of bulk filing of applications seeking to delete voters’ names from draft lists using Form 7 in Rajasthan, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh and, more recently Uttarakhand. Ground reports by *The Hindu* from Karnataka, Rajasthan and Gujarat noted that these forms were often filed in bulk fraudulently using names of people who were unaware of the filing. In several instances, hundreds of objections were filed under a single person’s name. Form 7 is filed to object to an existing name – or to request its deletion – on the electoral rolls for reasons such as death, shifting, or ineligibility. The ECI’s Booth Level Officer or the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) has to conduct an inquiry on the application and issue a notice to the voter before taking any action. While Booth Level Agents (BLA) of political parties can file up to 10 Form 7s a day, totalling 30, there is no limit on how many forms an individual registered as a voter from the same constituency can submit. To prevent misuse, the ECI has said that if a person files more than five objections, it will trigger a mandatory review by the ERO to ensure the legitimacy of the claims.

The Opposition parties have alleged that the form was being misused through “systemic and coordinated efforts” to delete names of eligible voters and embolden the BJP’s efforts to wrongfully gain electoral advantage. In the case of Uttarakhand, the Congress has alleged that the manner in which the bulk forms were submitted online pointed to “institutional” access being granted to some in the process. These parties have also sent delegations and submitted representations to the ECI. What is important to note is that in most cases, voters were unaware that applications for deletion of their names had been filed at all, leaving it to workers of political parties active in the constituency to bring it to their notice. According to ECI data, for the third phase of the SIR covering 16 States/three Union Territories there are 3,42,409 BLAs of political parties for an electorate of 36,73,87,831 or one BLA for approximately 1,073 voters. These numbers include agents from ruling and Opposition parties. In such a situation, it is incumbent upon the ECI to step in and protect the voting rights of an individual rather than leave it to the grassroot strength of political parties. The ECI should thus take immediate steps to address this concern. Abnormal patterns should be investigated and the process should be monitored, with a uniform, country-wide Standard Operating Procedure, requiring verification of identity and constituency of the objector and the following of due process before any elector is deleted pursuant to a Form 7.

Perfect host

India was successful as a host of badminton World Championships

The 2026 BWF World Championships in New Delhi marked the rise of France as an on-court force and of India as a capable host. Alex Lanier’s triumph in singles, and Thom Gicquel and Delphine Delrue’s in mixed doubles, were the first golds in France’s history. It was just over three months ago that the European nation finished a worthy runner-up to China in the Thomas Cup, the de facto World Cup in badminton. The Worlds success has established France as a serious contender in a sport otherwise dominated by Asian countries. In fact, Lanier is just the third non-Asian this century – after Spain’s Carolina Marin and Denmark’s Viktor Axelsen – to win the singles gold at the World Championships. The 21-year-old did that at a spruced-up Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, which was in the dock earlier in January when pigeons and monkeys intruded into the arena during the India Open. The massive facelift ensured that the marquee event’s return to India after 17 years would be long remembered. An Se-Young will also go back with happy memories after reclaiming the women’s singles crown from three-time titlist Akane Yamaguchi. The victory extended the 24-year-old reigning Olympic champion’s stellar 2026, during which she has won an Uber Cup gold medal, and the individual and team trophies at the Badminton Asia Championships.

For India, the competition was the 12th straight edition where it secured at least one medal, with Gayatri Gopichand and Treesa Jolly bagging a bronze in women’s doubles. The performance is the latest in a series of good outcomes for Indian badminton after an ordinary 2025, where Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty’s World Championships doubles bronze was the best result. This year, Lakshya Sen reached the All England Open final, and Ayush Shetty at the Badminton Asia Championships. P.V. Sindhu’s victory at the Japan Open Super 750 last month was only her second Tour title in the last four years, and there were also triumphs for Satwiksairaj and Chirag at Singapore Open Super 750, and for Devika Sihag, Tanvi Sharma and Ashmita Chaliha at the Super 300 level. Yet, the feeling is unmistakable that India should have done better at a home World Championships, with Lakshya’s second-round defeat to the unheralded American teenager Garret Tan the most disappointing. There is no questioning the 25-year-old’s capability; he is a World Championships bronze medallist, a two-time All England finalist and finished an agonising fourth at the Paris 2024 Olympics. But no Indian men’s singles player has won an elite BWF Super 1000-level title since K. Srikanth in 2017. A swift end to this drought is essential for the overall health of the sport.

On August 20, 2026, the Supreme Court of India delivered its judgment on the Reference made on the correctness of the judgment in *Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board vs A. Rajappa (BWSSB)*, 1978, particularly the test for determining whether an activity falls within the definition of “industry” under Section 2(j) of the Industrial Disputes (ID) Act, 1947. A brief history of the Reference. In *State of U.P. vs Jai Bir Singh (2005)*, 5 SCC 1, a five-judge Bench referred the seven-judge Bench decision in *BWSSB* for reconsideration. A seven-judge Bench was constituted and, by order dated January 2, 2017, referred the matter to a nine-judge Bench. By order dated February 16 2026, the nine-Judge Bench framed four questions concerning the correctness of the test in *BWSSB*, the impact of the 1982 Amendment and the Industrial Relations Code (IRC), 2020, whether government welfare activities count as “industrial activities,” and the scope of “sovereign functions” under Section 2(j).

By the time the questions were framed, the IRC, 2020 had been brought into force from November 21, 2025, also repealing the ID Act, 1947. By virtue of this repeal, the Reference had effectively been rendered otiose. Even so, the nine-judge Bench proceeded to hear the matter.

Judges and reactions

Of the nine judges, Justice D. Datta and Justice U. Bhuyan held that “the reference requires no answer”. Justice B.V. Nagarathna found the exercise “unnecessary and only academic in nature”. Justice P.S. Narasimha held that “an authoritative interpretation of the definition industry’ was compelling at the time of the Reference”, but “such a determination has now become unnecessary, with the repeal of the said provision.”.

Importantly, even the opinion written by the Chief Justice of India (CJI) for four judges acknowledges this. Even as it sought to re-formulate the Triple Test laid down by *BWSSB*, it describes its reformulation of the Triple Test as merely “hypothetical”, and expressly states that it will not apply to any pending case. The ID Act has been repealed, and there can be no future cases under it either. Even the reformulated test framed by four judges was prospective and would not alter pending disputes, which would continue to be governed by the *BWSSB* framework, and since the ID Act, 1947 has been repealed, there can be no future cases under it.

The four questions framed on February 16, 2026 concern only Section 2(j) of the ID Act. The interpretation of Section 2(p) of the IRC was not before the Court.

The CJI, writing for four judges, recognises that the IRC “is an independent legislative enactment and must be interpreted on its own terms, having



V. Gopala Gowda

Former Judge of the Supreme Court of India



Maitreyi Krishnan

Practising advocate

The top court’s treatment of *BWSSB* highlights the enduring anxiety over the scope of labour protection

regard to its text, scheme, and object”. At the same time, the same opinion says, in view of the reformulated Triple Test in their opinion, the principles laid down in *BWSSB* shall not be regarded as the “sheet anchor for the interpretation of the IRC should such a question arise in the future”. While on the one hand it refuses to construe a provision, in the same breath it rules on how *BWSSB*, as a precedent, may not be used to construe it. This in itself is a form of construing it, and is an attempt to police the tools available for a future interpretive exercise.

Justice Narasimha also says that it is important to ensure that the interpretation of the definition of “Industry” under the IRC “is not burdened by the existing interpretations” under the ID Act, 1947. Justice Nagarathna’s opinion on this issue is important. While affirming the judgment in *BWSSB*, she recognised that the extent to which its reasoning carries over to the interpretation of “industry” under the IRC is to be tested by comparing the actual text of the two provisions. Such a comparison can be meaningfully undertaken only in a case arising under Section 2(p), and not in the abstract.

The interpretation of the definition of industry under the IRC cannot be seen in abstract and would have to be understood in light of the rich jurisprudence that has developed with *BWSSB* and after.

The importance of *BWSSB*

There is a deeper thread – an anxiety about the judgment in *BWSSB*, which needs to be addressed. This anxiety is what gave rise to the Reference itself. The five-judge Bench in *Jai Bir Singh* (2005) questioned the correctness of *BWSSB*, observing that its “worker-oriented approach” was “unmindful of the interests of the employer or owner of the industry”.

This finds an echo in the CJI’s opinion. Having hypothetically reformulated the tests in *BWSSB*, and having stated that *BWSSB* shall not be regarded as the sheet anchor for the interpretation of the IRC, the opinion of the CJI, for four judges, speaks of the judgment finally lifting a “burden” and permitting the law to “move forward unencumbered”.

This again finds echo in the judgment of Justice Narasimha, who states that the interpretation of the definition of “industry” under the IRC, 2020 “must be freed of the bondage of ratio” in *BWSSB*. In this light, it is essential to recognise what “burden” of *BWSSB* causes such anxiety.

There can be no dispute about the asymmetry between capital and labour, or the imbalance in their respective bargaining power. Justice Bagchi recognises this when he reminds us that one must always “bear in mind that a workman seldom enters the field of negotiation as an

The fact is youth unemployment has a household cost



Gargi Sridharan

Economist



Basit Abdullah

Assistant Professor at the Institute of Management Technology, Hyderabad

Unemployment among educated youth in India extends beyond jobseekers, placing prolonged financial pressure on families

different question: what happens to families when an educated young adult cannot find work? How households experience that unemployment may depend not only on the absence of work, but also on how long the search lasts and on the resources families have to sustain it.

The households that invested in education

Around 15.4% of Indian households have a tertiary-educated young adult (18-29 years). These are households that have invested in higher education in the expectation that it would provide a pathway to secure employment and upward mobility. Yet, one in five households is supporting at least one unemployed tertiary-educated young adult (20.8%). The household consequences are measurable. Compared to households without any educated unemployed youth, those with unemployed youth spend, on average, ₹1,087 less per month on consumption overall, and ₹710 less per household member.

On average, these households have only 1.5 earning members, compared with two in households without an unemployed educated youth. For 14.4% of them, there is no active earning member at all, while 39.5% depend on a single earner. And in nearly two-thirds (62.5%), no one in the household has a regular salaried job.

The pressure on households becomes more serious when unemployment persists. Nearly three in five (58%) unemployed tertiary-educated youth have been searching for work for more than a year. Close to three in 10 (28.9%) have been unemployed for more than two years. A household supporting an unemployed graduate for a few months faces a different pressure than one financing a job search stretching across one or two years. Extended unemployment depletes savings, reduces consumption, and forces

equal....” The Constitution recognises this, with Article 42 requiring the state to secure “just and humane conditions of work,” while Article 23 prohibits “traffic in human beings”, “begar, and other forms of forced labour”. The conditions that necessitated these protections have simply changed form.

Labour legislation recognised this extreme imbalance and sought to ensure a modicum of bare protection. This is not a “pro-worker” understanding of the law, but just a check against the imbalance tilting toward the employer. The fact that such bare protection is described as “pro-worker” says less about the protection than about where the baseline has been unfortunately naturalised. While the freedom to dismiss without explanation is part of the ordinary run of business, a requirement to explain is called a burden. The warning of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar rings true – liberty from the control of the state is another name for “the dictatorship of the private employer”.

The 13-judge Bench decision in *Kesavananda Bharati* (1973) recognised that justice, social, economic and political, formed part of the Constitution’s basic structure. The underlying inequality between employer and workman has not narrowed since 1947. In fact, the policy of “ease of doing business” has widened it. This is exactly why the social justice vision of Part IV of the Constitution calls for more protection now, not less.

The issue of labour rights

The ID Act, 1947 – to maintain industrial peace – provided basic protections and a forum for adjudicating disputes, where the labour courts and tribunals have been given wide powers to adjudicate on the same. To be excluded from its definition of “industry” is to be excluded from that bare minimum protection, and from the remedy available under it. The significance of *BWSSB*’s definition of “industry” lay in ensuring that this protection reached everyone the Act was meant to cover, rather than excluding workers from the one recourse the law offered them.

Given the overarching objective of industrial peace, there was never a reason to treat *BWSSB*’s interpretation as a burden rather than as the Act doing precisely what it was designed to do. The anxiety surrounding it has always rested on the same premise: an eagerness to remove workers from the protection of the law.

As the ID Act stands repealed and the IRC takes its place, it is necessary to return to the promise of social justice in the Constitution. The labour codes that have replaced the ID Act, including the IRC, are built on a premise of exclusion – narrowing who falls within the protection of the law – and will have to answer to that mandate.

difficult choices about what employment the young adult should accept.

The data show a clear pattern: the ability to sustain prolonged job search is associated with household earning capacity. For someone in a household surviving on one earner or without a regular salary, the pressure to start earning is likely to arrive much sooner. What looks like the duration of an individual’s unemployment, therefore, is also a measure of how long a family must sustain the wait. These families must push their unemployed youth toward immediate employment, even if it means accepting positions far below their qualifications. The choice is not between a ‘good job’ and ‘bad job.’ It is between ‘any job’ and economic insecurity.

The policy question

Current employment policy largely treats youth joblessness as an individual problem, addressed through apprenticeships, skilling and hiring incentives. The evidence here suggests that the consequences of unemployment extend beyond the individual jobseeker to the household supporting them. The length of the transition from education to work also matters, because someone is financing that wait. Recruitment delays, prolonged selection processes and extended job searches impose very different costs on a household with several earners than on one relying on a single income or without a regular salaried worker. Therefore, employment policy needs to pay greater attention to how long young people remain unemployed, and to the economic circumstances of the families supporting them during that period. Reducing avoidable delays in entry into work is not only a labour-market concern; it can also reduce the strain that prolonged unemployment places on households.

The views expressed are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

AI-assisted learning

I write this letter as Professor of Medicine, Sri Ramachandra Medical College and Research Institute, Chennai. While the article, “Beyond the red pen” (EducationPlus, August 24), has laid out well-known aspects of learning using Artificial Intelligence (AI) into a crisp model (PRISM-X), it does not address the practical difficulties a human brain may face when using AI for

learning. The writers have rightly placed prompting efficiency first in the model since the first prompt in a conversation – which some call as the mother prompt – is critical. An AI model’s response is only as good as the prompt. I have observed that AI models are progressively designed in such a way that obtaining a good response requires longer and elaborate prompts. The bottleneck is “Reflective capability” in

learning through AI. Assuming that the user has good prompting skills, handling the AI output is not that easy. Reflective capability requires extensive background knowledge, a deeper understanding of current concepts, and an awareness of misconceptions and future applications. For this, the learner has to spend considerable time reading traditional books, articles and observing real-world

applications. So, it takes considerable time and effort for a person to challenge an AI model, identify misinformation and find wrong concepts put forth by the AI model. This means the world is perhaps stuck at the second stage of PRISM-X – not just students, but teachers as well. I fear that using AI without the skill for “Reflective capability” will, in the long run, erode learners’ thoughts and

make them accept half-truths — something which AI models are very good at. We need to educate students on how to upskill on “Reflective capability” before attempting to implement methods to assess their use of AI.

Dr. Emmanuel Bhaskar,
Chennai

Vacant seats

The report, “Over 13,000 UG seats still up for grabs at

Delhi University” (Inside pages, August 24), is not surprising. The vacant seats mirror the prevailing state of the education system in the country. Education no longer seems to guarantee employment or a livelihood. The National Education Policy needs a complete restructuring.

Balasubramaniam Pavani,
Secunderabad

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Smart glasses highlight gaps in privacy laws

In June, reality star Kylie Jenner posted her latest collaboration on social media – a new design for Meta’s line of AI-powered “smart glasses”. Images of her wearing the glasses filled social media, as did videos of her teenage self lamenting the lack of privacy she was afforded because of her fame. The irony was unmissable: how is Ms. Jenner, who was once so worried about privacy, now promoting a device that enables surveillance?

Smart glasses are the latest addition to the wearable technology space. It is also a dangerous example of how current laws are unable to keep up with today’s tech innovation.

According to Meta, these glasses allow you to see and answer calls, messages, and notifications via voice command. Built-in speakers help you listen to music and an integrated camera enables you to capture photos or videos through the lenses. Meta describes these glasses as “normal-looking eyewear with discreetly integrated glasses technology.” Hidden from the naked eye, these glasses contain “tiny speakers, microphones, [and] a lightweight camera.” The tech giant isn’t shying away from how inconspicuous these features are; rather, it is flaunting it.

Privacy and data concerns

In India, the glasses, which have been advertised everywhere, retail at around ₹25,000. Stickers that claim to completely cover the LED recording indicator are also widely available. Meta says that if the LED is covered, the glasses will block the recording until the sticker is removed. Yet, workarounds are just a Google search away. The glasses also make a shutter sound when they start and stop recording, but this is not a strong indicator that you are being recorded. Further, Meta argues that the glasses are “designed for privacy, controlled by you.” But this “control” is limited to the wearer, and not the recorded



Sonikka Loganathan

As wearable tech becomes more advanced, banning it will become increasingly difficult. Instead, laws should be framed with an understanding of how AI is changing the landscape

subject, such as requiring additional verification before use.

The website adds, “Meta collects data needed to help ensure that your glasses and app are reliable, secure and operating normally.” An investigation by Swedish newspapers *Svenska Dagbladet* and *Goteborgs-Posten* found that Meta’s contracted workers, who sometimes review the data to track user experience, were able to view sensitive content filmed on the smart glasses, including wearers using the toilet. In a comment to *BBC News*, Meta said its privacy policy states that it sometimes uses contractors to review data shared with them.

In this context, concerns about women’s privacy have grown. Data from the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) show that in 2023, before the glasses entered the market, there were 3,678 cases of women-centred cybercrimes. Of these, 2,767 cases involved the transmission or publication of sexually explicit material. Consider how much easier these glasses would make it to record people without their knowledge, including in private spaces. The potential risks to children are equally concerning. In 2023, the NCRB recorded over 698 cases related to the use or storage of child sexual abuse material. If adults cannot often recognise when the glasses are recording, a child certainly cannot.

These risks are compounded by the glasses’ battery life, offering 4-9 hours of active use. This means entire movies can be recorded, university lectures can be taped, confidential documents scanned, and patient information collected. It also means that even those who are not intentionally engaging in malpractice could invariably do so – by capturing something private in the frame’s periphery, for example. Ultimately, these glasses allow for the extensive, non-consensual collection of data.

Lacunae in the law

India’s laws today do little to

protect people from this surveillance. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDPA) is technologically agnostic, making the purpose of data collection the key consideration. In a public space, people can neither grant consent nor monitor how their information is used.

Following the landmark *K.S. Puttaswamy vs. Union of India* 2017 judgment, reasonable expectation of privacy was recognised as a fundamental right under Article 21. This means that people, even in public spaces, don’t generally expect to be captured in detail. But the DPDPA excludes information that is made publicly available. Hence, the reasonable expectation of privacy granted by *Puttaswamy* is not met because the Act does not regulate how someone is being recorded in public. The Act’s scope is diluted further since there are minimal indicators that you could be in someone’s frame, unlike someone recording on their phone.

This combination of rapid tech innovation and a lack of legal regulation and public awareness creates the perfect storm. With devices such as these glasses becoming common, people may be collecting information with little knowledge of where the data are being used. Without legal safeguards, digital accountability risks becoming an afterthought.

Banning such devices isn’t practical from a business or tech standpoint. Meta might be the biggest player in this space today, but Google and Reliance are also entering the smart glasses market. As wearable tech becomes more advanced, banning it will become increasingly difficult. Instead, laws should be framed with an understanding of how AI is changing the landscape. There is a need for assessments on how technology will evolve, the risks that may accompany it, and the government’s responsibility in ensuring that citizens are adequately protected.

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People’s Plan 2.0: an ambitious dream

A campaign which decentralised governance in Kerala is planning a comeback

STATE OF PLAY

Tiki Rajwi

On August 16, many of the best-known names linked to an ‘experiment’ that changed the way Kerala thought about democratic decentralisation came together in Thiruvananthapuram to celebrate a birthday. The People’s Plan Campaign (PPC) was turning 30 years old the next day. The conclave, a non-governmental initiative, saw participation from elected representatives, former Ministers and bureaucrats and hundreds of activists who had lovingly nurtured the PPC and gave it direction through the intervening years. But more than a nostalgic anniversary reunion, it was meant to discuss and plan the ‘People’s Plan Campaign 2.0’.

The plan, as explained by Communist Party of India (Marxist) veteran and former Finance Minister T.M. Thomas Isaac, who had been in charge of the PPC when he was a member of the Kerala State Planning Board, included student internships with local bodies and a tech-driven campaign coordinated through an online portal. Opening the August 16 event, K.M. Shaji, Minister for local self-government in the ruling Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government, recalled how successive governments in Kerala had supported the PPC as a process of deepening democracy.

A rich history

The PPC as an idea traces its roots to the ‘Gram Swaraj’ concept of Mahatma Gandhi. It draws strength from the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments, and the enactment of the Kerala Panchayati



Raj Act and the Kerala Municipality Act which institutionalised local governance structures. Kerala officially launched the People’s Plan Campaign on August 17, 1996. At the time, it was run on campaign mode as the concept of participatory planning was new to the people. Grama sabhas and urban ward assemblies were organised across the State in the months that followed. The Left Democratic Front (LDF) government also took the big step of devolving 35%-40% of the Plan outlay to local governments.

The State Planning Board’s Economic Review had noted how the programme marked a major shift by placing local self-governments at the centre of development planning. With its rich history of social reformation through the late 19th and early 20th centuries, the land reforms that transformed the agrarian system, and its high social indicators in literacy and health, Kerala was ideally suited for such an experiment.

Looking back, the programme may not have been a 100% success, but it was also far from a failure. It made participatory democracy deeper and local governments stronger. The ‘Kudumbashree’ scheme in particular grabbed the spotlight on national and international stages. As noted by Mr. Isaac and Richard W. Franke, Professor Emeritus at the Montclair State University,

in their book *People’s Planning – Kerala, Local Democracy and Development*, “from a mere government-led administrative reform, the PPC has made the process of decentralisation an object of mass action and a part of the popular politics.”

Modern challenges

Yet, as an updated 2.0 version is being ambitiously discussed, the challenges are many, such as waning public enthusiasm and low participation in the grama sabhas, especially in urban areas. When compared to the 1990s, attracting the younger generation to such an endeavour in a fast-paced, rapidly urbanising Kerala would prove a ponderous task, but also the most vital one. Government estimates show that 96.43% of Kerala’s population could be living in urban areas by 2036. The People’s Planning 2.0 would then have to factor in many things: centralisation trends in the government, changing aspirations of the people, and the increasing fiscal stress faced by Kerala.

Yet, the spirit of co-operation fostered through programmes such as the PPC remains all the more relevant today. Many of the hurdles faced by local governments in the last 30 years – unemployment, waste disposal, gender justice and issues faced by marginalised sections – persist. Moreover, more demanding problems have emerged: limited income sources, climate change, and an ageing society. In these changed times, local bodies would need to evolve a new political and fiscal culture with stronger public involvement, and elected members with impeccable credentials.

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Hyderabad, adjoining ACs drive Telangana’s record SIR deletions

Just 20 constituencies in and close to the capital city account for half of the State’s deletions

DATA POINT

Pon Vasanth B.A.
Srinivasan Ramani
Areena Arora

At the end of the enumeration period of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process in Telangana, the State registered a 21.7% deletion of names from its pre-SIR electoral rolls, the highest in the country so far. **Table 1** shows the percentage of deletions in the major States where the SIR has been undertaken. The draft electoral roll in Telangana will see the addition and re-entry of electors following the corrections period, but even taking that into account, the 21.7% figure is a rather large one. Only Uttar Pradesh with 18.7%, Tamil Nadu with 15.2%, and Gujarat with 14.5% come close to Telangana in the draft-stage deletion rate.

Map 1 shows the deletion rate across Assembly Constituencies (ACs) in the State. In 21 ACs, the deletion rate was a whopping 35% or more, and 19 of these fall in the “Highly Urban” band. Most were in and around the cities of Hyderabad and Secunderabad – Musheerabad registered the highest deletion rate in the State at 45.2%, followed by Sanathnagar (44.9%), Malakpet (44.8%), Lal Bahadur Nagar (44.4%), Jubilee Hills (44.1%), Secunderabad Cantonment (42.8%) and Serilingampally (42.7%). The smaller map shows the 15 constituencies of Hyderabad district. Across the 21 “Highly Urban” constituencies, nearly 70% of those deleted were taken off the rolls because they had “shifted”.

Unlike States such as Bihar, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, West Bengal, Chhattisgarh and Kerala, which recorded a drop in gender ratio between their 2024 Lok Sabha rolls and their final SIR rolls, Telangana’s draft rolls show a slight increase – the ratio rose from 1,018 in the pre-SIR roll to 1,028 in the draft roll (**Table 2**). Ta-

mil Nadu saw a similar bump, from 1,034 in its 2024 Lok Sabha roll to 1,044 in its final SIR roll. Telangana’s figure, however, is at the draft stage and could still change.

The urban-rural split in terms of deletions was sharp (**Table 2**). In “Highly Urban” constituencies, the deletion rate was 40.4%. In “Moderately Urban” constituencies it was 29.8%, but that figure is driven by the peri-urban belt adjoining Hyderabad rather than by the district towns: Maheswaram (41%) and Rajendranagar (38.9%), both in Rangareddy district, Patancheru (31.9%) in Sangareddy district, and Medchal (31.5%) in Medchal Malkajgiri district all recorded rates at or above the “Highly Urban” range. The urban seats in the same band were lower – Warangal West at 28.9%, Nizamabad (Urban) at 27%, Khammam at 24.6%, and Warangal East at 19.5%.

In contrast, in the “Moderately Rural” and “Highly Rural” constituencies, the deletion rate was much lower – 12.37% and 11.92% respectively. In the former category, again, several of the highest deletion rates are in areas not far from Hyderabad. Among “Highly Rural” constituencies, Achampet (16%), Makthal (15.7%), Mudhole (14.9%), and Yellandu (14.6%) registered the highest deletion rates.

To classify Telangana’s 119 constituencies, night-time light intensity from SHRUG database maintained by Development Data Lab was used. And for each constituency, the average brightness across its area was calculated. Because a few city seats are far brighter than the rest, the values were first converted to a logarithmic scale, then grouped using Jenks Natural Breaks – a standard mapping technique that finds the cut-off points where the data separate most naturally – into “Highly Urban”, “Moderately Urban”, “Moderately Rural” and “Highly Rural”.

More granular analyses will follow in forthcoming articles.

(With inputs from Swathi Vadlamudi)

A great purge

Telangana is likely to witness the biggest drop in its electoral rolls compared to other major States if the ongoing ‘Claims and Objections’ phase of the Special Intensive Revision does not bring more voters back onto the rolls



TABLE 1: Share of deleted voters did not change much in most of the major States between draft and final SIR rolls

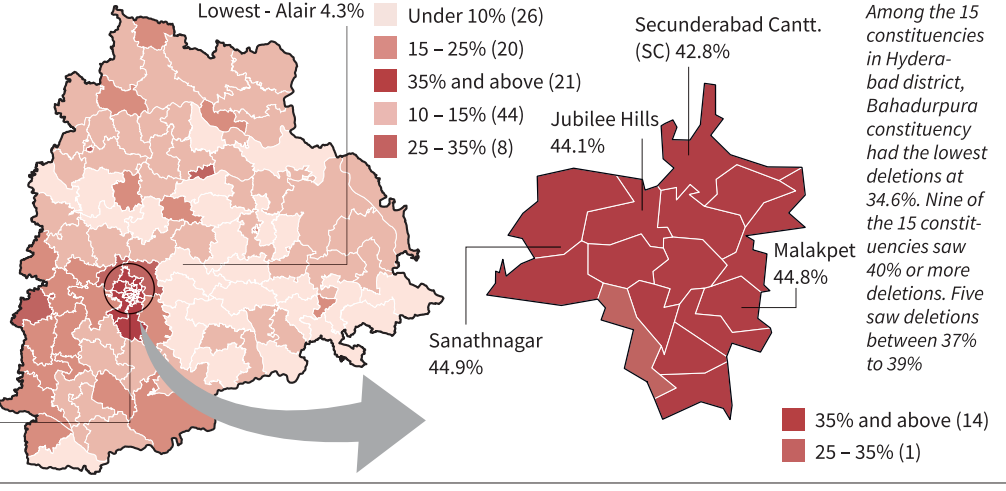
State	Deletions % compared with pre-SIR rolls	
	in draft SIR rolls	in final SIR rolls
Telangana	21.7	-
Uttar Pradesh	18.7	13.2
Tamil Nadu	15.2	11.6
Gujarat	14.5	13.4
Chhattisgarh	12.9	11.8
Kerala	8.7	3.2
Bihar	8.2	6
Rajasthan	7.7	5.7
West Bengal	7.6	8.1
Madhya Pradesh	7.5	6

TABLE 2: Deletions were concentrated in urban areas, with 21 highly urban ACs losing roughly four out of every 10 voters

Measure	Highly Rural	Moderately Rural	Moderately Urban	Highly Urban	All Telangana
Assembly constituencies (ACs)	21	65	12	21	119
Pre-SIR share in electorate (%)	14.02	47.24	13.84	24.89	-
Share in electorate, draft SIR (%)	15.78	52.87	12.40	18.95	-
Female per 1,000 male, pre-SIR	1,044	1,052	996	954	1,018
Female per 1,000 male, draft SIR	1,025	1,038	1,027	1,004	1,028
Deletions	5,65,518	19,77,351	13,96,366	34,00,000	73,39,235
Deletion (%)	11.92	12.37	29.83	40.38	21.7
- shifted (%)	52.28	50.54	61.96	69.38	61.58
- absent (%)	7.58	12.10	20.23	19.50	16.73
- death (%)	25.42	21.18	8.46	7.11	12.57
- duplicate (%)	14.72	16.18	9.34	4.02	9.13

MAP 1:

All the 21 constituencies that saw deletions of 35% or more in the draft SIR rolls were in and around the Hyderabad region



Among the 15 constituencies in Hyderabad district, Bahadurpura constituency had the lowest deletions at 34.6%. Nine of the 15 constituencies saw 40% or more deletions. Five saw deletions between 37% to 39%

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO AUGUST 25, 1976

Dhillon wants sustained road safety campaigns

New Delhi, August 24: Although the standard of public transport has considerably improved sustained campaigns to educate the public about road safety along with regular drives to check over-speeding, violation of traffic regulations and driving under the influence of liquor would greatly help to minimise the rising incidence of road accidents in the country.

This was stated by Dr. G.S. Dhillon, the Union Minister of Shipping and Transport, while inaugurating the 13th meeting of the Transport Development Council here this morning.

Dr. Dhillon said the procedure regarding issue of driving licence and fitness certificate would also need to be tightened so that only competent and experienced persons secured the driving licences and fitness certificate issued to mechanically sound vehicles.

He said it would have a deterrent effect on rash and negligent driving if persons responsible for accidents were to pay compensation to the victims of their families in all cases.

Referring to the national permit scheme for goods transport which aims at removal of hurdles in the free movement of vehicles, Dr. Dhillon said that out of the total number of 5,300 permits allotted in various States, nearly 3,000 permits had been issued in pursuance of this scheme which formed part of the 20-point economic programme of the country.

The Minister also drew the attention of the members to the scheme regarding mechanisation of cycle rickshaws and requested them to strive for its early implementation in order to improve the economic conditions of the rickshaw pullers.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO AUGUST 25, 1926

Imperial bank of India

Calcutta, August 25: The Imperial Bank of India has fulfilled its undertakings to open hundred new branches within five years. The announcement was made yesterday by Mr. H.C. Edmondson, while presiding at the annual general meeting of shareholders on the Calcutta register of the Bank. The burden of opening majority of the new branches, he said, fell on Bengal Circle which opened 66, while seven new sub-agencies and pay offices were also established.

Congress targets Modi govt. on price rise and unemployment

The party flags rising prices of food items, including sugar, onions, and milk; party president Mallikarjun Kharge points out that graduates account for 67% of unemployed Indians aged 20 to 29; he slams govt. for absence of jobs after graduation

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday targeted the Narendra Modi government over unemployment and price rise, with party president Mallikarjun Kharge accusing the government of “completely ravaging” young India’s entire pathway from education to employment.

Mr. Kharge cited a recent NITI Aayog report estimating that 8.7 crore Indians in the 15-29 age group were not studying, working, or receiving training. Youth unemployment stood at 15.6%, rising to 19.5% among young women, he said, citing the Periodic Labour Force Survey for July.

“Where are the jobs after graduation,” Mr. Kharge asked in a post on the so-



Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge has accused the government of putting the youth’s future at risk. FILE PHOTO

cial media platform X, pointing out that graduates account for 67% of unemployed Indians aged 20 to 29. He questioned the promise of creating two crore jobs every year, saying that by that calculation, 24 crore jobs should have been created in 12 years.

Mr. Kharge alleged that lakhs of government posts

remained vacant, while secure employment was increasingly being replaced by contractual and part-time work. “Expensive and inadequate education, paper leaks, delayed recruitment, a widening skills gap, and disappearing quality jobs have put the future of an entire generation at risk,” he said.

“You, Modi*ji*, promised to achieve what previous governments could not do in 70 years! You have certainly delivered on that boast: an education system that costs more, infested with RSS (Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh), examinations young Indians cannot trust, and degrees that increasingly come without jobs,” the Congress chief said.

The NITI Aayog report, “Reimagining skilling for Viksit Bharat@2047”, based on data from the 78th round of the National Sample Survey conducted in 2021, has called for subsidised training programmes to encourage self-employment, and align skills with local demand and emerging sectors.

The Congress also attacked the government over the rising prices of es-

sential commodities. The party’s communications chief, Jairam Ramesh, cited a media report on a sharp rise in onion prices, saying prices in Nashik had increased by around 76% in a month, while wholesale rates had doubled in some States.

“After sugar, now onions too are slipping out of the common man’s reach,” Mr. Ramesh said on X. The government’s buffer stock was empty, he said, adding that the rising prices of milk, oil, fruits, and other essential commodities were adding to the burden on households.

“The Modi government, which claims to have ushered in *achche din* (good days), should explain how the poor and middle class were expected to make ends meet,” Mr. Ramesh said.

Citing vacancies, Congress chief says Modi government is trying to end reservation

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday accused the Narendra Modi government of seeking to undermine reservation through what it termed a “back door” route, citing more than 8.2 lakh sanctioned posts lying vacant across civilian Central government establishments.

The figures showed that the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government’s policy of “conspiring to end” the constitutional rights of disadvantaged communities had been exposed, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said.

The charge came amid the ongoing “reservation *hatao*” (remove reservation) campaign, seeking to end caste-based reservations in government jobs and educational institutions.

Sharing a Ministry-wise

Over 8.2 lakh sanctioned posts are lying vacant across civilian Central govt. establishments

breakup of the vacancies on social media platform X, Mr. Kharge said the number had risen from 4.21 lakh in 2015 to 8.24 lakh in 2024.

According to the figures cited by him, the Railways had 2.40 lakh vacant posts, while the Defence Ministry had 2.41 lakh vacancies. The Home Ministry had another 1.10 lakh vacant posts, Mr. Kharge said.

He also alleged that 5.1 lakh permanent jobs had been eliminated in public sector undertakings, while the share of contractual workers had increased from 19% to 49%.

“The question is not just about employment, but

about social justice,” Mr. Kharge said. He argued that keeping government posts vacant would effectively deny reserved-category candidates opportunities, while the sale of PSUs and increasing contractual employment would further shrink the availability of jobs covered by reservation.

“To end reservations, it is not necessary to amend the Constitution – just eliminating jobs with reservations is enough,” he said.

The Congress president alleged that the BJP’s approach was aimed at weakening the constitutional safeguards for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Other Backward Classes, and Economically Weaker Sections.

The Congress has sought to frame vacancies and changes in public employment as part of a wider question of social justice.

‘Standard practice’ followed, say officials on U.S. envoy remarks

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Indian officials followed the “standard practice” of checking the modalities for public appearances by Prime Minister Narendra Modi ahead of his meeting with U.S. President Donald Trump on the sidelines of the G7 summit in France earlier this year, official sources said on Monday.

This comes hours after U.S. Ambassador Sergio Gor claimed that the External Affairs Ministry had asked for the press event not to feature questions. Mr. Gor went on to say that Mr. Trump subsequently forgot about the purported request and went on to answer questions from journalists for 45 minutes.

“Discussions regarding arrangements for public appearances of leaders are normal practice ahead of any VVIP visit. In this regard, the Indian side communicated its standard practice for such visits,” a source said, referring to the interaction between Mr. Modi and Mr. Trump in Evian, France, on June 17, 2026.

Addressing a media conclave on Sunday, Mr. Gor said the Ministry had an “ask” regarding making the meeting between the two leaders free of questions from the press.

Mr. Trump, however, forgot about the Indian side’s “ask”, Mr. Gor



Sergio Gor

claimed, and proceeded to answer questions. “A 45-minute press conference followed, and everything was on the table,” he said.

Official sources, however, pointed out that during the press interaction, all questions, both from U.S. and Indian presspersons, were aimed at Mr. Trump and that Mr. Modi was not asked any questions.

‘PM afraid of media’ Meanwhile, the Congress said the office of the Prime Minister was being “diminished and disrespected”.

In a post on X, Congress leader Pawan Khera said Mr. Gor’s remarks were revealing, suggesting that avoiding questions from the media was a regular practice under Mr. Modi. “Why is Modi so afraid of facing the media?” he asked.

In another post, Mr. Khera said Mr. Trump had not taken Mr. Modi’s concerns seriously. “A compromised PM is not taken seriously,” he said.

Opposition raises concerns over ‘weakening’ of ISRO; Centre hits back

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The government and the Opposition sparred on Monday over the future of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), with Congress general secretary (communication) Jairam Ramesh raising concern over a reported privatisation push in the space sector, and Union Minister of State for Science and Technology Jitendra Singh asserting that the country’s space programme was being “scaled up”, not scaled back.

Reports about ISRO’s future role had raised “legitimate concerns”, given the capabilities it built over six decades under scientists, including Vikram Sarabhai, Satish Dhawan, Brahm Prakash, U.R. Rao, and A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, Mr. Ramesh said.

ISRO’s role in rocket development and manufacturing could be “severely limited”, he alleged, adding that a substantial part of its satellite-related assets could be transferred to private companies. He questioned the reported plan to hand over the second spaceport being developed at Kulasekarapattinam in Tamil Nadu, for which ISRO is investing



Union Minister of State for S&T Jitendra Singh says ISRO is focusing on frontier missions such as Gaganyaan. FILE PHOTO

about ₹1,000 crore, to a private company.

‘Over 100 resignations’

“The future of the historic Sriharikota spaceport in Andhra Pradesh is itself anybody’s guess,” Mr. Ramesh said. He also claimed that 100-120 key ISRO professionals had left the organisation in recent months, “perhaps seeing the writing on the wall”.

Responding to Mr. Ramesh, Dr. Singh accused him of being determined to “run down every Indian achievement”.

“ISRO is not being weakened. It is being enabled to concentrate increasingly on the frontier missions – Gaganyaan, Chandrayaan-4, the Bharatiya Antariksh Station, and future missions to the moon,

Venus and Mars,” the Minister said. As India targets 50 launches a year, industry would have to emerge as the manufacturer at scale while ISRO focused on developing next-generation technologies and missions, Dr. Singh said. He described this as the “natural evolution” of the space programme.

More start-ups

Citing the expansion of private participation, he said India now had more than 440 space start-ups, and referred to the July 18 launch of Skyroot Aerospace’s Vikram-1, which he said was the first privately developed Indian rocket to reach orbit. “That is not ISRO’s legacy being diluted. That is ISRO’s legacy bearing fruit,” Dr. Singh said.

Space sector is expanding: BJP

NEW DELHI

The BJP on Monday said that India’s space programme was expanding. Responding to MP Jairam Ramesh’s charge, BJP spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari said: “I understand your frustration with India’s remarkable journey in space. But the numbers tell a story that is difficult to ignore.”

The government was targeting a \$44-billion space economy, requiring private rocket factories, satellite manufacturing facilities, and a deeper supply chain, alongside ISRO’s research and frontier missions, he said.

Sriharikota would remain central to major programmes, including PSLV, LVM3 and human spaceflight, while Kulasekarapattinam would add capacity for the growing small-launch sector, he said.

Dr. Singh also cited the increase in foreign satellites launched by ISRO from 35 before 2014 to more than 430, and Chandrayaan-3’s successful landing near the Moon’s south polar region, to highlight the government’s space strategy.

Rules at tribal hostels undermining dignity of students, says Rahul

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Monday wrote to Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis alleging that rules governing tribal hostels were undermining the dignity and access to education of students and said Adivasi students had been on hunger strike for over 10 days.

In his letter to Mr. Fadnavis, Mr. Gandhi followed up on interactions with students in Pune during the *Chhatron ki Gunj* (echo of students) programme last Saturday. He said students from across Maharashtra had told him about hostel rules that “strip them of their dignity and shut off their path to education”. Mr. Gandhi said female students returning after an extended absence were required to undergo pregnancy tests and other medical examinations to establish their “fitness”.



Rahul Gandhi

This was an “attack on their dignity and humanity”, he said.

He also alleged that hostels were unsafe and often lacked food, sanitation and medical care, with students suffering injuries and deaths, including from snake bites.

Earlier in the day, the party had sought a special committee to probe the deaths of tribal children allegedly due to malnutrition in Madhya Pradesh and of tribal girls following snakebite in Maharashtra. Adivasi Congress chief Vikrant Bhuria also called for a safety audit of tribal hostels.

‘PM taking forward Sant Ravidas’s ideals’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

BJP president Nitin Nabin on Monday said Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s leadership was taking forward Sant Ravidas’s ideals of social harmony, equality and selfless service, with development reaching the poorest of the poor.

He was speaking at the party’s *Samrasa Sankalp Abhiyan* (Social Harmony Pledge Campaign) event, organised to mark the 650th birth anniversary of Sant Shiromani Ravidas, a Bhakti poet, who fought for the marginalised sec-

tions of society.

Mr. Nabin said that under the Modi government, development schemes were being delivered to the poor and the last person in society. About 25 crore people had been brought out of poverty, he said. He said the BJP’s resolve was to unite every section of society and realise the goal of a Viksit Bharat by 2047.

Among those present were Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, BJP State president and Minister of State Harsh Malhotra. Mr. Nabin said the party’s entire cadre was carrying forward the campaign.

BJP leaders question Rahul

BJP leaders have questioned Opposition leader Rahul Gandhi’s remarks on the *Manusmriti*. Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma said he was using women’s empowerment as a pretext to target Hinduism.

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NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING (NCB) / OPEN TENDER ENQUIRY (OTE)
BRBNMPL invites bids under two-bid systems from eligible bidders for following e-tender through MSTC portal.

1. Tender No. 021/MYS/MMD/2026-27, MSTC EVENT No. BRBNMPL/Mysuru Press/MMD/22/26-27/ET/45 [IP-PBX SYSTEM] - Design, Supply, Installation, Commissioning, Performance Testing and Non-Comprehensive AMC of IP-PBX System (with Buy Back) at BRBNMPL, Mysuru.

Last date and time of tender submission is on or before 25/09/2026 by 11:00 AM. For downloading tender documents, and other details, kindly visit our website **www.brbnmpl.co.in** and **www.mstccommerce.com**. Any modification will be notified on above websites only.

Sr. General Manager

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, BALANGIR (R&B) CIRCLE, BALANGIR
e-Procurement Notice - BID IDENTIFICATION No.CGE(R&B)ZGR/05/2026-27
Letter No.2438 // Dtd.21.08.2026

The Chief Construction Engineer, Balangir (R&B) Circle, Balangir on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bid in double cover system in **ONLINE MODE** for the construction of works detailed in the table below from **"A" & "B" Class Contractor** registered with the State Governments and contractors of equivalent Grade/ Class registered with Central Government/ MES/ Railways for execution of Civil works. The proof of registration from the appropriate authority shall be enclosed along with the bid.

1. Nature of Work

2. No. of tender

3. Tender Cost

4. Class of Contractor

5. Date & Time of sale & Receipt of Bids

6. Date of Opening of Bid

7. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website: http://tendersorissa.gov.in. All future corrigendum will be available on ONLINE MODE only.

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Rs.10,000/-

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Dt.18.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M.

Chief Construction Engineer, Balangir (R&B) Circle, Balangir.
34001/691/2627

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GOVERNMENT OF INDIA – DEPARTMENT OF SPACE CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC – SHAR SRIHARIKOTA – 524124

Brief E-TENDER NOTICE

e-Tender Notice No. PT-E-26-014
On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for the following works:

Sl.No	Brief Name of work	Value (Rs)
1	Annual maintenance contract for CMG electrical installations at different zones of SDSC SHAR for a duration of two years (2026-28)	133.40 Lakhs

Last date for sale (Tender documents can be downloaded) upto 08/09/2026 14:30 hrs. For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website <https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html> and tender free view at <https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro>

Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/ SDSC SHAR

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क्रमांक :- EO/RUVAS/2026-27/165
दिनांक :- 17/08/2026

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 11/2026-27
राजस्थान पशु चिकित्सा एवं पशु विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, (जोबनेर), जयपुर की ओर से राज्य / केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संतर्गत / विभागों में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से आनलाइन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।
निविदा से संबंधित अन्य आवश्यक विवरण वेबसाइट <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> व <https://ruvasjaipur.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर देखी जा सकती है।

Sr. No.	Name of Work	NIT Amount (In Lacs)	Contract Period	Tender Fee	EMD (2%)	Processing Fee
1	Building Work for Centre of Excellence & Rajasthan Institute of Veterinary Science at PGIVER Campus, Jaipur.	915.00 Lacs	18 Months	5000/-	18300000/-	2500/-

1. धरोहर राशि, निविदा शुल्क एवं प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क, संपदा अधिकारी राज. पशु चिकित्सा एवं पशु विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, (जोबनेर), जयपुर के खाते में जमा करायानी है।

Bank Name	ICICI BANK
BRANCH NAME	RHB MANSAROVER, JAIPUR.
ACCOUNT NO.	677601702188
ACCOUNT HOLDER NAME	Estate Officer Rajasthan University of V and A Sciences Jobner Jaipur
IFSC CODE	ICIC0006776

2. निविदा प्रत्यक्ष / दस्तावेज दिनांक 17.08.2026 से दिनांक 09.09.2026 तक रात 6:00 बजे तक वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर देखी जा सकती तथा निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 10.09.2026 को प्रातः 11:30 बजे खोली जावेगी।
3. प्रसारित निविदा के सम्बन्ध में किसी भी प्रकार की जानकारी Estate Office RUVAS, (Jobner) Mansarovar, Jaipur कार्यालय से कार्यदिवस एवं कार्यालय समय में प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
UBN No. : RVJ2627/WLOB000025
राज.संवाद/सी/26/10427

सम्बद्ध अधिकारी
रुवाल (जोबनेर) जयपुर

A BG-BGE

INBRIEF



Daily life affected as heavy shower hits Delhi-NCR region

Heavy showers in many parts of north India on Monday triggered flight diversion, waterlogging, and massive traffic disruption, especially in the the Delhi-NCR region, which received the bulk of the rainfall. Traffic snarls were the worst in Gurugram where parents carrying children on their shoulders were seen wading through flooded roads and vehicles were seen stuck on waterlogged roads. Vehicles were stuck in water around Rajiv Chowk, while school buses and ambulances were also caught in waterlogging on Sohna Road. At least 15 flights were diverted, scores delayed, and some cancelled at the Delhi airport due to inclement weather conditions. PTI

3 arrested for gang rape of teenager in Madhya Pradesh

Three men have been arrested for the alleged gang rape of a 17-year-old girl in Madhya Pradesh's Pachmarhi, the police said on Monday. According to the police, the incident took place on August 19 when the survivor was waiting at a bus stop with her male friend when a vehicle driver arrived there with two other men and took them to a dense forest. Speaking to *The Hindu*, Narmadapuram Range Deputy Inspector-General of Police Birendra Kumar Singh said: "The three accused took the victims in their car by black-mailing them using their photographs. In the forest, they tied up the boy and assaulted the girl."

Bank unions call nationwide strike on September 11

The United Forum of Bank Unions (UFBU) will begin a nationwide strike on September 11 over the delay in implementing a five-day banking week, differences over performance-linked incentive schemes, and several other pending demands, including pension related issues. The UFBU, an umbrella body of nine bank employees' and officers' unions, has also threatened a subsequent three-day nationwide strike beginning September 28, coinciding with half-yearly closure. They have also decided to go on an indefinite strike from October 26 onwards.The decision was taken at a meeting held on Sunday with the UBFU. PTI

56 in hospital after gas leak at Nagpur water treatment plant

At least 56 people were hospitalised after a leakage in a 900-kg-capacity chlorine gas cylinder at the water treatment plant of the Maharashtra Jeevan Pradhikaran in Nagpur district on Monday, officials said. The leak was detected in the two chlorine gas cylinders at the Godhani water purification plant in the morning hours. Under the guidance of the Nagpur Collector, the Directorate of Health Services, industrial safety authorities and an NDRF team coordinated to mitigate the potential danger from the accident, said a release. At present, 45 people remain hospitalised, of whom eight are receiving treatment in the ICU. PTI

Panel will take up complaints of sexual assault by police: SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Monday said women protesters could directly approach the nodal officer of the High Powered Enquiry Committee with complaints of sexual molestation against police personnel during the crack-down on NEET-UG protests on July 20 in New Delhi.

The nodal officer of the panel would be a judicial officer. The court's explanation came in response to an oral mentioning made by senior advocate Shobha Gupta. Ms. Gupta said there should be separate, sensitive mechanism for women protesters to file their complaints and seek legal action against police personnel.

The court suggested the panel take up, on a priority basis, allegations of targeted violence, harassment, and molestation of female protesters. It was urged to assess the grievous harm and injury allegedly caused to protesters by police authorities and security personnel.

Bills on simultaneous elections unconstitutional: Cong. leader

Chidambaram tells JPC proposed legislation violates Constitution's Basic Structure; think tanks point to infirmities; while some Padma awardees support move, others say it can lead to chaos

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Former Union Minister P. Chidambaram on Monday strongly opposed the proposal for simultaneous Lok Sabha and Assembly elections while appearing before the Joint Committee of Parliament (JPC) examining the Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, 2024, and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024.

He described the initiative as "monstrous", "mindless" and "unconstitutional".

According to sources, Mr. Chidambaram told the committee that the proposed legislation, which seeks to synchronise Lok Sabha and Assembly elections under the "One Nation, One Election" framework, violates the Constitution's Basic Structure. The senior Congress leader argued that curtailing the tenure of a legislature elected for a fixed five-



P. Chidambaram

year term would directly undermine constitutional principles and parliamentary democracy.

'Govt. lacks majority'

The former Home and Finance Minister said his conscience did not permit him to support the Bills, and contended that the government lacked the required two-thirds majority needed for the constitutional amendment. Sources said the committee recorded his concerns and invited specific suggestions and recommendations for improving the legislation.

The committee, headed

by BJP MP P.P. Chaudhary, held a three-part meeting on Monday. The first part was with Mr. Chidambaram, second part with Padma awardees, and third with two independent think-tanks.

A group of 10 Padma awardees, including Tarlochan Singh, Navin Khanna, Meenakshi Jain and Niru Kumar, appeared before the panel. While some supported simultaneous elections, others cautioned that the move could create "chaos" in the country.

Ms. Jain argued that repeated enforcement of the Model Code of Conduct disrupted development projects, and said synchronised elections would allow uninterrupted implementation of regional development programmes.

Dr. Saumitra Rawat said continuous election cycles affected academic calendars and entrance examinations such as NEET, while cardiologist Ashok Seth pointed to the strain

recurrent polls placed on the healthcare system through repeated diversion of medical and administrative personnel.

Many of the Padma awardees recommended clearer statutory provisions governing election schedules and timelines for fresh elections.

The committee later heard submissions from Nation First Policy Research and the Vidhi Centre for Legal Policy, both of which suggested that the law in its present form has many infirmities. The organisations called for clearly defined and judicially reviewable grounds for postponing Assembly elections, fixed outer limits for any deferment, and mandatory parliamentary oversight.

They also stressed the need to avoid governance vacuums during election deferrals, suggesting either structured limits on President's Rule or caretaker governments restricted to routine administration.

Simultaneous polls possible in 2029, says panel chief

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Holding simultaneous elections for the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies in 2029 under "One Nation, One Election" is possible if the Constitution is amended and State governments support the move, according to P.P. Chaudhary, the Chairman of the panel examining the related Bills.

Mr. Chaudhary said on Monday that if the constitutional amendment is approved in Parliament by 2028, the rollout of "One Nation, One Election" can begin that same year.

"Under the Indian Constitution, the States are empowered to hold simultaneous polls," he said after a meeting of the panel.

Mr. Chaudhary said there may be different opinions of political parties, but the committee has to work together in the interest of the country.

Mr. Chaudhary said the Parliament mandated the committee to fix the short-comings, if any, and make sure that the simultaneous polls are held successfully.

Centre moves to simplify medical device regulations

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

The Union Health Ministry has proposed amendments to the Medical Devices Rules, 2017, to promote ease of doing business. The amendments seek to simplify regulatory requirements, standardise testing fees and facilitate faster market access for eligible medical devices.

The Centre has eased regulatory requirements for medical device manufacturers by removing the need for a separate licence for outsourced sterilisation and expanding the list of countries and regulatory jurisdictions whose approvals can facilitate waiver of clinical investigation requirements in India, a release issued by the Ministry said on Monday.

Under the proposed amendment to Rule 44, manufacturers that outsource sterilisation of their medical devices to a facility holding a valid licence under the Medical Devices Rules, 2017, will no longer have to obtain a separate



The change is intended to balance regulatory oversight with ease of doing business.

loan licence for the sterilisation activity.

Earlier, manufacturers had to secure a separate loan licence even when the outsourced sterilisation facility itself held a valid licence. The government said removing the duplication would reduce paperwork, administrative burden and compliance costs, particularly for manufacturers without their own sterilisation facilities.

However, a traceability requirement has been retained. Manufacturers will have to mention the licence number of the sterilisation facility on the medical device label. A six-month transition pe-

riod has been provided to allow companies to modify labels, packaging and related processes.

The government said the change was intended to balance regulatory oversight with ease of doing business by retaining traceability while simplifying the licensing framework.

In another change, the amendment to Rule 63 includes the European Union (EU) among the stringent regulatory jurisdictions recognised for waiving clinical investigation requirements for medical devices that do not have predicate devices in India. The provision already recognises the United States, the United Kingdom, Australia, Canada and Japan. With the EU now included, medical devices approved in the EU that meet the eligibility conditions can benefit from the waiver provisions in India. The move is expected to reduce regulatory timelines for importers and manufacturers and facilitate quicker availability of newer medical technologies to Indian patients.

Education Minister reviews 'key priorities' to strengthen CBSE

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi convened a meeting with officials of the Department of School Education and Literacy on Monday to address controversies surrounding the Central Board of Seco-

dary Education (CBSE). "The meeting reviewed key priorities for strengthening CBSE's academic, examination and administrative processes, with a focus on greater efficiency, transparency and improved support for students and teachers," Mr. Joshi wrote on X.

Centre lifts ban on wheat exports amid depressed local prices

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The government on Monday lifted the export ban on wheat and its products with immediate effect and said the decision was aimed at boosting farmers' income amid depressed domestic prices.

Early this year, the government had allowed ex-

port of 50 lakh tonnes of wheat and 10 lakh tonnes of wheat products. India, the world's second-largest wheat producer, banned wheat exports in May 2022 as part of measures to control rising domestic prices.

The government has also removed export ban on wheat flour and other products such as maida, semolina, and wholemeal atta.

SC notice to Jharkhand on plea on exam irregularities

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday issued notice to the State of Jharkhand and the Jharkhand Public Service Commission on a petition seeking an independent, time-bound Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into alleged malpractices in the Jharkhand Combined Civil Services Preliminary Examination.

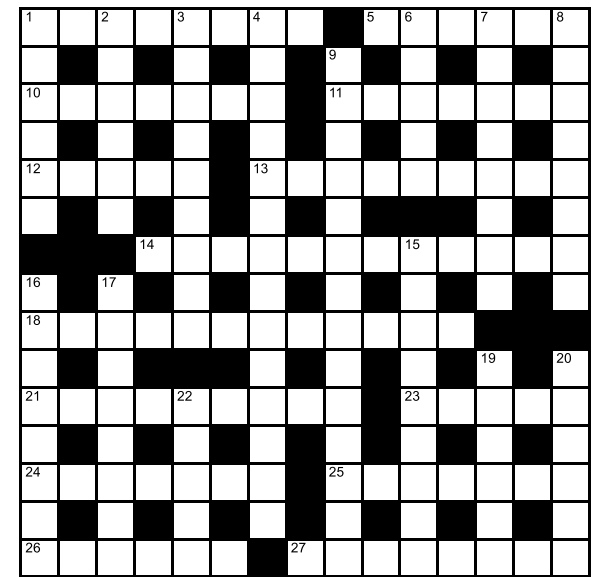
A Bench headed by the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant was hearing a petition filed by activist Harisharan Devgan, represented by senior advocate Manan Kumar Mishra and Satyam Singh Rajput.

Students had been protesting for over a month against alleged malpractices in the State-conducted exam, Mr. Mishra said. It was imperative to have the allegations in the case probed by an independent agency, such as the CBI, rather than the State CID, which is currently investigating the case, he added.

THE CROSSWORD+ 14881

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

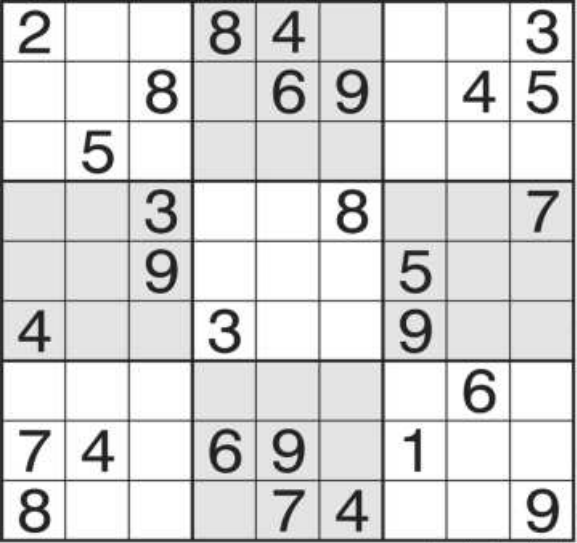
SCAN TO PLAY



- 14 Cynthia baked crackers some time ago (4,2,3,3)
- 18 Inadequate actions that pint drinkers avoid? (4,8)
- 21 Love to cuddle over essentially comfortable mat in front of fireplace (9)
- 23 Ruffle Republican in charge (5)
- 24 A con is running outside institute in capital city (7)
- 25 Invalidate union with sick, regressive fellow in New York (7)
- 26 Provides vehicles to tour Tenerife on vacation (6)
- 27 Extremely wealthy youth at premiere consuming ecstasy in fact is naive (4-4)
- Down
- 1 Starts to malign inept member, very upset about bloomer (6)
- 2 Group enthralled by alcohol, in euphoria (4,2)
- 3 Raised millions to acquire secluded place producing milk (5,4)
- 4 New tea maker with new lid worked very well (4,4,1,5)
- 6 British coppers in compound caught rogue finally (5)
- 7 Bond interrupts criminals making agreements (8)
- 8 Bows and arrows at first removed from terribly rusty case (8)
- 9 Go nude in revel, cavorting after consuming cocaine in excess (14)
- 15 Hydrogen and nitrogen extracted essentially in a careful manner (9)
- 16 Infernal leader of hoodlums restrained by chief, shot in the arm (8)
- 17 Straightforward copper probing violent cartel (5-3)
- 19 Cotton fabric turning yellow, fraying at centre (6)
- 20 Romped in Portugal with hot European lady (6)
- 22 Revolting scoundrel grabs son on base - it's shocking (5)

- Across
- 1 Master dwelt on awful accident in nuclear reactor (8)
- 5 Extract from ripe cacao that's used to induce vomiting (6)
- 10 Mysterious moans in stately home (7)
- 11 Wine merchant beginning to visit model in secret (7)
- 12 Look at hunk, ultimately sexy (5)
- 13 Thievish con lures a drunk (9)

SUDOKU



Solution to previous puzzle

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

FAITH

Celebrating Prophet's birth

Milad-un-Nabi, also known as Mawlid al-Nawabi, marks the observance of the birth of the Islamic Prophet Muhammed. Celebrated on the 12th day of Rabi 'al-Awwal, the third month of the Islamic calendar, this occasion holds deep spiritual significance for millions of Muslims across the globe. The day serves primarily as a sacred time for reflection, gratitude and remembrance, said Syed Meeran.

Rather than a grand, ostentatious holiday, Milad-un-Nabi is centered on honouring the life, teachings and noble character (*Akhlaq*) of Prophet Muhammed. Devotees gather in mosques, community centres and homes to listen to lectures detailing his life story, recite poetry in his praise (Nats or Mawlid compositions) and readings from the Koran.

Central to the celebration is the message of universal peace, compassion and charity. Prophet Muhammed is regarded in Islam as Rahmatan lil-Aalamin (a mercy to the worlds) and the observance emphasises his legacy of kindness towards the poor, social justice, forgiveness and community service. Across many traditions, communities prepare elaborate feasts, distribute food to the less fortunate and organise charitable drives to honour his altruistic spirit. Emulating the Prophet's concern for the vulnerable families and feeding them is a core aspect on this day. Ultimately, Milad-un-Nabi is more than a historical commemoration. It acts as an annual renewal of faith, encouraging believers to embody the Prophet's virtues – honesty, humility, patience and love – in their daily lives, strengthening social harmony and spiritual growth.

Business

INBRIEF



SEBI unveils index for market infrastructure institutions

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has introduced an Information Technology Resilience Index (ITRI) for market infrastructure institutions (MIIs), including stock exchanges and depositories, as part of efforts to strengthen the resilience of their IT systems. In a circular, the markets regulator said the index would assess the MIIs across nine parameters, including availability, security, integrity, governance, reliability and monitoring, business continuity, modularity and flexibility, scalability, and other relevant factors. SEBI said that the MIIs would be required to develop an Early Warning System (EWS) to detect any deterioration in ITRI parameters that could potentially lead to performance issues, system slowness or other disruptions, and take remedial measures.

Third Wave Coffee raises ₹408 crore in funding

Third Wave Coffee, a Bengaluru-based coffee and food firm, has raised ₹408 crore in a funding round led by existing investor WestBridge Capital while the round also witnessed participation from Creagis and other angel investors. The new funding is expected to fuel Third Wave Coffee's next phase of expansion, with capital directed towards geographic growth in existing markets, building greater density in high-potential cities and strengthening the brand's ability to serve a wider range of consumer occasions, according to the company. Third Wave Coffee has accelerated its national footprint by entering Ahmedabad, Mangalore and Agra last year while strengthening its presence across Delhi, NCR, Hyderabad, Chennai, Mumbai and Pune. In June 2026, it entered East India with three cafés in Kolkata. The firm is currently evaluating opportunities in other eastern markets, including Guwahati, Ranchi, Patna and Bhubaneswar.

In-principle nod for airports' privatisation

Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee approves proposal for third round of privatisation covering 11 airports in five bundles

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The government's Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC) has given in-principle approval to the Ministry of Civil Aviation's proposal for the third round of airport privatisation, covering 11 airports across five bundles, according to a government document.

The proposal will now move towards securing the PPPAC's final approval, following which it will be placed before the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA).

The 11 airports being considered for privatisation in five bundles include Amritsar and Kangra; Varanasi, Gaya and Kushinagar; Bhubaneswar and Hubballi; Raipur and Aurangabad; and Tiruchirappalli and Tirupati.



The airports being considered for privatisation include Amritsar and Kangra; and Tiruchirappalli and Tirupati. FILE PHOTO

Responding to the PPPAC Chair's concern over the risks of oligopolistic concentration and over-leveraging in the airport sector, the Ministry of Civil Aviation said it plans to cap the number of airport bundles that can be awarded to a single bidder.

The modalities for the proposed cap are being finalised and will be submitted as part of the proposal seeking the PPPAC's final recommendation, according to the Record of Discus-

sion dated August 20.

The issue of bidder concentration gained prominence following the previous round of airport privatisation, in which the Adani Group won bids for all six airports on offer.

At the time, the PPPAC had rejected key recommendations from the Finance Ministry and NITI Aayog, including a limit of two airports per bidder and requirement for prior airport operations and management experience.

UPI turns a decade-old, sees 13,000-fold surge in transaction volume

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Unified Payments Interface (UPI), launched on August 25, 2016 by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), has completed 10 years of transforming digital payments in India.

UPI has emerged as the backbone of India's digital payments ecosystem and a critical driver of financial inclusion, the Finance Ministry said in a release.

Over the decade, UPI's annual transaction volume expanded from 1.78 crore transactions in FY17 to over 24,162 crore transactions in FY26, representing a 13,000-fold surge in transaction volume.

Transaction value rose sharply from ₹0.07 lakh crore in FY17 to approximately ₹314 lakh crore in FY26, translating into a more than 4,000-fold increase in transaction value, the Ministry said.

UPI is currently opera-



Annual transaction volume expanded from 1.78 crore in FY17 to 24,162 crore in FY26.

tional in 11 countries and has emerged as one of the most successful pillars of digital public infrastructure, providing an interoperable, real-time payments platform that enables seamless peer-to-peer and peer-to-merchant transactions via a single application. "By bridging the digital divide, advancing financial inclusion, and expanding access to digital financial services, UPI has empowered individuals and communities across the country while driving broad-based economic participation," it added.

TCS to buy out Porsche's MHP for €320 mn EV

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) is planning to fully acquire MHP Management-und IT-Beratung GmbH (MHP), Porsche AG's Germany-based management and IT consulting subsidiary, for an enterprise value of €320 million, excluding customary post-closing adjustments for net debt and working capital.

The acquisition is part of a broader €1.25 billion, five-year strategic partnership between TCS and Porsche under which TCS will provide artificial intelligence (AI) services across Porsche's mobility value chain. The transaction and partnership remain subject to regulatory approvals, with the acquisition to be completed through a TCS subsidiary.

TCS will establish a dedicated AI Mobility Centre of Excellence for Porsche. The centre will focus on deploying AI-driven solutions across manufacturing, engineering, operations and customer experience.

MHP reported a CY 2025 turnover of €742 million and has 4,500 employees. Besides Germany, the company operates through subsidiaries in Romania, the U.K., the U.S., India and Mexico. "MHP brings strong automotive and industrial consulting and implementation experience, with strengths in business transformation, AI, SAP, manufacturing digitalisation, and connected mobility," TCS said.

Domestic sugar prices fall, volatility remains a concern

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE/NEW DELHI

With the Centre's announcement last week permitting import of 10 lakh tonnes of raw sugar, domestic prices are cooling down. However, the price volatility remains a matter of concern.

The current sugar marketing season that began

on October 1 last year saw a substantial quantity of sugar sold at ₹38-39 a kg (ex-mill price).

Prices started going up in January, to ₹48 a kg, and stood at ₹56 a kg on Monday (Maharashtra ex-mill price).

The price was ₹58 a kg (Maharashtra ex-mill) on August 22 and ₹62 a kg on August 21.

An industry source said the ex-mill prices are likely to hover between ₹50 and ₹60 till Nov. - December.

Office-bearers of the Indian Sugar & Bio-Energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA) told reporters in New Delhi on Monday that the recent firmness in sugar prices should not be construed as shortage of sugar in the country.

India's sugar balance remains fundamentally comfortable, with net sugar production for 2025-2026 (sugar season) estimated at around 279 lakh tonnes (LMT) against domestic consumption of 280-285 LMT, and projected closing stocks of about 35 LMT.

Adequate stocks are available to ensure uninterrupted domestic supplies

through the transition into the next sugar year.

The recent increase in sugar prices is the result of a convergence of temporary factors, including lower-than-initially-expected production, heightened festive-season demand, market sentiment, and firm international sugar prices, according to the ISMA.

Haryana: Godrej to invest ₹20,000 crore

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI



Godrej Properties Ltd (GPL) will be the key driver of expansion.

Godrej Industries Group is eyeing up to ₹20,000 crore investment in the State of Haryana generating almost 40,000 jobs.

It signed a memorandum of understanding with the State government under which the firm would build upon about ₹12,000 crore it had already invested till date.

Godrej Ventures, the Group's real estate private equity arm, has invested about ₹1,000 crore in the State so far and plans to deploy an additional ₹3,500 crore towards Grade A+ office infrastructure in Gurugram. The office investments alone is likely to generate over 30,000 direct and indirect jobs, Pirojsha Godrej, Chairperson, Godrej Industries Group said.

Godrej Properties Ltd (GPL) is expected to be a key driver of the Group's expansion, with plans to invest ₹16,000 crore in Haryana by FY28.

GPL currently has 18 projects across Gurugram, Sonapat, Faridabad, Panipat and Kurukshetra. Its future expansion plans are expected to extend beyond residential development.

Tata's Oriental Hotels, IHCL set to merge

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Indian Hotels Company Limited (IHCL), India's largest hospitality company belonging to the Tata Group, has announced that Oriental Hotels Limited (OHL) will be merged with it through a Scheme of Arrangement.

An exchange ratio of 25 IHCL shares for every 117 OHL shares has been set for the all-stock transaction which is targeted for completion in H2FY28.

Value creation

"The merger will drive long-term value creation by leveraging IHCL's strong balance sheet to support strategic investments, including inventory expansion and product enhancements strengthening the

Oriental Hotels is an associate company of IHCL with a portfolio of seven hotels with 825 rooms

premium positioning of the portfolio," said Puneet Chhatwal, MD and CEO, IHCL. Oriental Hotels is an associate company of IHCL with a portfolio of seven hotels with 825 rooms.

OHL holds investments in several IHCL group hotel companies in India and internationally, including the St. James Court.

"The merger of OHL with IHCL will create significant value for OHL shareholders, enabling them to now participate directly in IHCL's growth journey," said Pramod Ranjan, MD & CEO, Oriental Hotels.

ALLEN eyes ₹3,800-crore IPO to fund institute's expansion

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI



Allen opens Mangaluru Centre.

ALLEN Career Institute, a 38-year-old test-preparation firm, is gearing up for major expansion across India, backed by technology investments, selective acquisitions and a proposed initial public offering (IPO) of about ₹3,800 crore.

The Kota-based education firm, which has grown from a family-run coaching institute into a professionally-managed, technology-enabled education business, is looking to use the IPO proceeds to accelerate regional expansion and strengthen technology, artificial intelligence (AI) and

automation capabilities.

Organic/inorganic route The firm is also evaluating expansion into additional markets through a combination of organic growth and selective acquisitions,

said CEO Nitin Kukreja.

The strategy comes as indigenous coaching industry is projected to grow from about \$32 billion to \$52 billion by 2030 while the K-12 supplementary education market represents an opportunity of more than \$19 billion, according to sector estimates cited by the company.

In 2022 Bodhi Tree Systems, a joint venture between James Murdoch's Lupu Systems and former Disney Asia Pacific chief Uday Shankar, acquired a 20% stake in Allen Career Institute for \$600 million. The company is believed to have crossed ₹3,700 crore in revenue in FY26.

IndiGo's Gangwal to give ₹300 cr. to IIT Kanpur

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

IIT Kanpur alumnus and IndiGo co-founder Rakesh Gangwal has committed an additional ₹300 crore towards the development of the Gangwal School of Medical Sciences and Technology at IIT Kanpur.

This follows the ₹100 crore donated in 2022, which supported the institute's initial plans to set up the medical school. The project envisages a 500-bed super-speciality hospital on the campus along with a 200-bed cancer care and research centre.

ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಸರ್ಕಾರ ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ
ಕಾರ್ಯಪಾಲಕ ಅಭಿಯಂತರವರ ಕಛೇರಿ, ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ, ದಾವಣಗೆರೆ ವಿಭಾಗ, ದಾವಣಗೆರೆ.

ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ ಸಂ: ಐಎಫ್‌ಟಿ-15/ಎಇ-1/2026-27/1593 ದಿನಾಂಕ:24.08.2026

ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಅವಧಿ ವಿಸ್ತರಣೆ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ

ವಿಷಯ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಅವಧಿ ವಿಸ್ತರಣೆ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ ಮಾಡುವ ಬಗ್ಗೆ.
ಉಲ್ಲೇಖ: ಈ ಕಛೇರಿ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ ಸಂಖ್ಯೆ : ಕಾಅ/ಲೋಇ/ದಾವಿ/ಐಎಫ್.ಟಿ-15/ಎಇ-1/2026-27 ದಿನಾಂಕ: 18.08.2026.

ಈ ಕಛೇರಿ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ ಸಂಖ್ಯೆ: ಐಎಫ್‌ಟಿ-15/2026-27 ದಿನಾಂಕ : 18.08.2026ರ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಕರೆಯಲಾಗಿದ್ದು, ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆಯಲ್ಲಿನ ಕ್ರ.ಸಂ.5, 6 & 7ರ ಕಾಮಗಾರಿಗಳಿಗೆ ಸಂಬಂಧಿಸಿದಂತೆ ದಿನಾಂಕಗಳನ್ನು ತಾಂತ್ರಿಕ ಕಾರಣಗಳಿಂದ ಈ ಕೆಳಕಂಡಂತೆ ಮುಂದೂಡಲಾಗಿದೆ.

1. ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಬಗ್ಗೆ ವಿಚಾರಿಸಲು/ಮಾಹಿತಿ ಪಡೆಯಲು ಕೊನೆಯ ದಿನಾಂಕ 24.08.2026 ಸಂಜೆ 4.00 ಗಂಟೆಯವರೆಗೆ

2. ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಸ್ವೀಕರಿಸಲು ಕೊನೆಯ ದಿನಾಂಕ : 31.08.2026 ಸಂಜೆ 4.00 ಗಂಟೆಯವರೆಗೆ

3. ಬಿಡ್‌ಗಳನ್ನು ತೆರೆಯುವ ದಿನಾಂಕ : 01.09.2026 ಸಂಜೆ 4.30 ಗಂಟೆಯವರೆಗೆ ಉಳಿದಂತೆ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕ್ರಿಯೆಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಯಾವುದೇ ಬದಲಾವಣೆ ಇರುವುದಿಲ್ಲ. ಹೆಚ್ಚಿನ ವಿವರಗಳನ್ನು ಸದರಿ ಕಛೇರಿಯ ಕೆಲವು ವೇಳೆಯಲ್ಲಿ (ದೂರವಾಣಿ : 08192 234951, 231530) ಅಥವಾ ವೆಬ್ ಸೈಟ್ <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> ನಲ್ಲಿ ಪಡೆಯಬಹುದು.

ವಾಸಾಇ/ಡಿಎಸ್/294/ ಸಹ/- ಕಾರ್ಯಪಾಲಕ ಅಭಿಯಂತರರು,
ಕೆಎಸ್‌ಎಂಎ/2026-27 ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆ ವಿಭಾಗ ದಾವಣಗೆರೆ

BENGALURU WEST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer,
Special Division, Zone-2, 19th Main Road,
2nd Block, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-560010

No.: EE/SD/TEND/16/2026-27 Date: 24.08.2026

INVITATION FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Short Term Tender Notification (Two Cover System)
(Through GOK KPP Portal only)

The Executive Engineer - Special Division, Zone-2 invites Expression of Interest from eligible tenderers for the work detailed in the table below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Service
1	Empanelment of Agencies and Fixing Rate contract on "PER METRIC TONNE (MT)" Basis for complete cleaning, Removal, loading, transportation, weightment and disposal of debris from private vacant sites to the designated location as notified by BWCC. EMD Amount in Rs.: 50,000/-.

Calendar of Events: (1) Date of commencement of download of document from KPPP website: From **25.08.2026.** (2) Date and time for pre-bid meeting: On **27.08.2026** at **3:00 p.m.** (3) Last date and time for uploading tenders in KPP Portal: On **31.08.2026** upto **4:00 p.m.** (4) Date and time of opening Technical bid: On **01.09.2026 @ 4:30 p.m.** (5) Date and time of opening of Financial bid: **will be intimated.** Further details may be obtained from the above office, during office hours or website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.

Sd/- Executive Engineer, Special Division, Zone-2, Bengaluru West City Corporation

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

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1800 102 1878

Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU thehindu businessline.

FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR THE HINDU

KARNATAKA HOUSING BOARD
3rd Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bengaluru - 560009.

TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only)

Karnataka Housing Board invite tenders from the eligible Pre qualified contractors & willing to Pre qualify in Karnataka Housing Board through Karnataka public procurement portal for below mentioned works.

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1	Construction of Sub-Registrar Office Building at Mysuru South, Mysuru District & KR Pet, Mandya District and Modernization works to Sub-Registrar Office at Mysuru North, Mysuru District. Tender Reference Number: KHB/2026-27/BD/WORK_INDENT 781 & IFT No.48/2026-27 Date: 20.08.2026. Amount Put to Tender: Rs. 3,00,97,225/-
2	Construction of Sub-Registrar Office Building at Kuderu Village, Yellandur Taluk, Chamarajanagara & Hannur Taluk, Chamarajanagara District. Tender Reference Number: KHB/2026-27/BD/WORK_INDENT 782 & IFT No.49/2026-27 Date: 20.08.2026. Amount Put to Tender: Rs. 1,43,71,436/-

Last date for submission of bid: 03.09.2026 upto 4.00 PM

For further information, contact below mentioned office address: Executive Engineer, Karnataka Housing Board, Cauvery Bhavan, Bengaluru. Telephone No: 080-22273511, Website: <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Sd/- Executive Engineer, Karnataka Housing Board, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/2395/AKAR/2026-27

INSTITUTE OF NEPHRO-UROLOGY
(Government of Karnataka-Autonomous Institute-Regd. No. 1052/03-04)
(A Post Graduate Institute of Higher Medical Sciences, Affiliated to Rajiv Gandhi University of Health Sciences, Bengaluru. Recognised by Medical Council of India) Victoria Hospital Campus, Bengaluru-560 002.

E-Mail: nephrourology.institute@gmail.com Ph.No.: 080-26700460
No: INU/Est(1)/01/2026-27 Date: 24.08.2026

ABSTRACT RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION

Applications are invited from the eligible candidates for medical teaching posts i.e Assistant Professors in various departments at Institute of Nephro-Urology, Bengaluru and Mysuru branch. From the eligible candidates as per eligible criteria mentioned in the detailed notification **No. INU/Est(1)/01/2026-27 dated: 24.08.2026.** They Shall also comply with the roster requirements as mentioned therein. **Notification-01 (Local Parent Cadre): 02 Posts and Notification-02 (Residual Parent Cadre): 18 Posts (1 Backlog).**

The detailed Notification can be accessed from the Institution's **website: <https://nephrourology.karnataka.gov.in>.** Candidates are required to submit their applications online through the dedicated portal link mentioned in the detailed Notification on or before **10.09.2026 at 4.00 P.M.**

Note: The deadline for submitting applications and any other changes will be published on the institution official website.

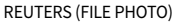
Assistant Professors		
Sl. No.	Department	Posts
1	Urology (1 in Mysuru Unit)	09
2	Nephrology	05
3	Bio-Chemistry	01
4	Microbiology	01
5	Pathology	01
6	Radiology	02
7	Anesthesiology (Mysuru Unit)	01
Total		20

Sd/- Director, Institute of Nephro-Urology, Bengaluru.

Syrian court sentences Assad-era's top religious cleric to life in prison



U.S. cancels joint marine drill with S. Korea, citing Iran war demands



Yemen's Houthis claim attack on Saudi Arabian oil tanker in Red Sea



Japanese lawmakers embark on China visit with aim to mend ties



U.S. vows 'economic asphyxiation' of Iran with new set of sanctions

U.K. to help Ukraine build long-range missiles: PM

U.S. administration proposes \$1.03 lakh fee for H-1B visas

Mannar locals fear ecological fallout amid Sri Lanka's green energy push

RAISING THE BAR

Pant is India's top wicketkeeper run-getter in away Tests



ANI

Rishabh Pant went past M.S. Dhoni to become the country's highest run-getter as a designated wicketkeeper in away or neutral Tests. The left-hander has 2,534 compared to Dhoni's 2,496. Pant also overtook Adam Gilchrist to become the third-highest six-hitter in Test cricket. He has 102 maximums while Gilchrist smashed 100.

ONE OF A KIND

Pant plays his shots and I cannot bat like him, feels Jurel



PTI

Rishabh Pant's century partnership with Dhruv Jurel helped India gain dominance in the second Test. Referring to his flamboyant batting partner, Jurel said: "Test cricket has different ways of playing. Pant plays his shots and I cannot bat like him. With his experience, he would talk about which bowler can be taken down".

PENALTY

Jaiswal and Asitha fined for breaching code of conduct



AP

India opener Yashasvi Jaiswal and Sri Lanka seamer Asitha Fernando were both fined 25% of their match fee for breaching Level 1 of the ICC Code of Conduct during the second Test. The two were involved in a heated exchange on Sunday. One demerit point each has also been added to their disciplinary records.

NOT SHYING AWAY

Fulton takes full responsibility for the team's poor performance



FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

I think the outcome was bigger than the performance. I think that got the better of us. If we had just gone back to our normal approach, which I was hoping we would, it would have been different. I take full responsibility for that — India men's hockey team head coach Craig Fulton after the team's World Cup exit.

Jurel and Pant turn up the heat on a rain-hit day

The two put on 112 for the seventh wicket as India declares its first innings at 503 for nine; Sri Lanka tottering at eight for two in reply; only 56 overs of play possible due to interruptions

INDIA IN SRI LANKA

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

The afternoon turned grim, dark clouds hung low, skyscrapers became silhouettes and vanished entirely from view. The rain was that intense, cascading in waves, just like how Arundhati Roy wrote in *The God of Small Things*: "Slanting silver ropes slammed into loose earth, ploughing it up like gunfire."

The liquid intervention at 2.13 p.m. lasted 23 minutes. The efficient ground staff at the Sinhalese Sports Club Ground covered the entire turf in sheets and the venue was not ploughed. But the showers forced a break during the second Test's second day at a time when India was coasting against Sri Lanka.

Gradually the clouds receded, the sun emerged and play resumed at 4.22 p.m., with India placed on 475 for eight and Dhruv Jurel on 95. He took his time, was stationary on 99 for a while before scampering for a single after tapping Asitha Fernando towards mid-off. Later he hoisted

SCOREBOARD

INDIA — 1ST INNINGS
Yashasvi Jaiswal b Asitha 45 (53b, 9x4), K.L. Rahul c Dickwella b Kumara 18 (33b, 2x4, 1x6), Devdutt Padikkal b Nuwantha 117 (193b, 12x4), Shubman Gill c Dickwella b Asitha 50 (108b, 6x4), Rishabh Pant c Udara b Nuwantha 63 (89b, 6x4, 2x6), Ravindra Jadeja b Asitha 43 (83b, 4x4), Dhruv Jurel (not out) 115 (177b, 9x4, 2x6), Saransh Jain c Mishara b Asitha 6 (8b, 1x4), Manav Suthar c Dickwella b Prabath 18 (51b, 2x4), Mohammed Siraj lbw b Prabath 3 (29b), Prasidh Krishna (not out) 4 (7b, 1x4); Extras (b-8, lb-3, nb-3, w-7): 21; Total (for nine wks. decl. in 138 overs): 503.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-37 (Rahul, 10.4 overs), 2-66 (Jaiswal, 16.6), 3-186 (Gill, 51.5),

the seamer for a big six. Even as Mohammed Siraj left and last-man Prasidh Krishna appeared, Jurel (115 n.o., 177b, 9x4, 2x6) ensured that India crossed 500. Aptly Shubman Gill declared the first innings at 503 for nine. At close, Sri Lanka was struggling at eight for two with Yashasvi Jaiswal's diving catch to terminate Lahiru Udara's stint being the highlight. India's batting effort rested entirely on two wicketkeeper-batters – the maverick Rishabh Pant and the efficient Jurel.

4-281 (Padikkal, 76.2), 5-296 (Jadeja, 84.1), 6-307 (Saransh, 86.5), 7-419 (Pant, 112.1), 8-458 (Suthar, 124.4), 9-489 (Siraj, 136.1).

SRI LANKA BOWLING
Asitha 29-5-106-4, Kumara 20-4-68-1, Prabath 42-7-132-2, Nuwantha 38-3-154-2, Dinusha 3-0-8-0, Dhananjaya 2-0-8-0, Mishara 4-0-16-0.

SRI LANKA — 1ST INNINGS
Lahiru Udara c Jaiswal b Prasidh 1 (6b), Kamil Mishara (batting) 5 (5b), Prabath Jayasuriya lbw b Suthar 2 (7b); Total (for two wks. in three overs): 8.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-1 (Udara, 1.2), 2-8 (Prabath, 2.6).

INDIA BOWLING
Siraj 1-0-1-0, Prasidh 1-0-1-1, Suthar 1-0-6-1.

Their 112-run seventh-wicket partnership anchored India past the 400-mark. Pant (63, 89b, 6x4, 2x6) fell off the first ball after lunch, while trying to clear long-off against off-spinner Keshara Nuwantha. Jurel, though, remained calm. He accumulated runs at a steady trot even as Manav Suthar flickered a while before edging left-arm spinner Prabath Jayasuriya. After Siraj walked in, Jurel held onto the strike as much as he could while the former defended. Jurel on-drove Asitha for four and then the skies opened up.

Earlier, resuming at 300 for five, India lost Saransh Jain as he awkwardly fended a short-pitched delivery from Asitha. But there were no Monday morning blues as Pant, who had retired hurt on the opening day, returned. Lahiru Kumara steamed in and pitched it short around the leg-stump. Pant just swivelled and pulled a massive six that hit the roof. While Jurel remained patient, Pant was busy. Host skipper Dhananjaya de Silva placed fielders at fine-leg, third-man, backward square-leg and sweeper-cover. Pacers, be it Asitha or Kumara, ran in and bounced, hoping for a miscued hit. Pant remained unruffled, and suffered a few blows too as he ducked and weaved. He pinched some fours off Nuwantha while Jurel pulled Asitha past the ropes. Prabath found Pant drilling one straight down the ground and soon the batter reached his 50. Jurel too followed suit and then Pant whipped a six off Prabath over mid-wicket as India moved to 419 for six at lunch. Pant dominated the first act, and it was time for Jurel to flourish in the second part. He precisely did that for his second Test century.



Perfect mix: Jurel brought up his second Test hundred with a blend of caution and aggression. ANI

Playing Test cricket is a privilege, says Jurel

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

Time seemingly paused as Dhruv Jurel batted on 99. With Mohammed Siraj for company, and an anxious Indian camp watching from the dressing room, Jurel took 13 deliveries to move to his coveted hundred while surviving a run out attempt too in the process. His knock deflated host Sri Lanka in the second Test.

Speaking to the media here on Monday and recalling the nervous 90s phase, Jurel said: "When I was on 99, he (Asitha Fernando) started bowling good lengths. When I played that shot (for the hundred), I thought it was going past the fielder and that there was a gap, but then I was like oh, God!"

On a stop-start day due to the rains, Jurel seemed at ease. "I am used to it, because I was here with India-A and am aware of the situation, about the (rain) breaks. I was just trying to bat in partnerships and also assess the conditions. Even if I scored a 100 to-



day, tomorrow I will go and start from zero, that's how it is." When Sri Lanka turned up for the first innings, Jurel donned the big gloves. "Right now, (Rishabh) Pant has a sore right shoulder. We are closely monitoring him. Today I kept wickets, hopefully he will be fit," said Jurel. Among the rivals, Jurel lauded Asitha: "It was so hot and he used the short ball. It's not easy for a bowler, and he was really challenging, especially when I was on 99." Stressing that playing red-ball cricket is important, Jurel said: "Playing Test cricket is a privilege. We want to play well both in white and in blue".

Abid's five-for puts North on top; East in command

DULEEP TROPHY

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

Abid Mushtaq's left-arm spin bamboozled West Zone as North secured a 64-run first-innings lead on day two of the Duleep Trophy quarterfinals at the BCCI Centre of Excellence here on Monday. The Jammu & Kashmir twacker excelled with a fine five for 39 as West, starting from 31 for two, was bundled out for 187, with only Shams Mulani showing a semblance of fight (52, 94b, 7x4, 1x6). And by the time a combination of bad light and rain ended proceedings, North was 171 runs in the green with Ayush Badoni at the crease on a confident 39 (49b, 5x4), and six wickets and two days remaining. Abid had served an appetiser late on the opening day by casting West opener Prithvi Shaw with a classic left-arm spinner's delivery. In the opening session of day two, he ran through the middle-order, bowling 11 overs, conceding 13 runs and claiming three wickets. Chief among those dismissals was that of captain



Wrecker-in-chief: Abid ran through the West Zone middle-order. ALLEN EGENUSE J.

Ruturaj Gaikwad. The Maharashtra batter stepped out of the crease, only for the red cherry to dip and hold its line. Ruturaj tried to cover for his error by offering his pad first. The unimpressed umpire gave him his marching orders. Two balls later, Urvil Patel was also trapped in front, and it was only apt that Abid provided the finishing touches by sending back No. 10 Tushar Deshpande just before tea to complete a much deserved five-wicket haul. On the adjacent ground, the contest between East and North East moved at a more frenetic pace.

From an overnight 355 for six, East raked up 467 and then shot out its opponent for a paltry 111, with Tripura medium-pacer Abhijit Sarkar scalping five for 20 runs. With two days to go and a mammoth 349 runs in the red, India's newest – and weakest – cricket zone has a near-impossible task. The scores: North Zone 251 & 107/4 in 21 overs vs. West Zone 187 in 65.4 overs (Shams Mulani 52, Abid Mushtaq 5/39). East Zone 467 in 112.5 overs (Kumar Kushagra 55, Sudip Gharami 146, Shahbaz Ahmed 167) vs. North East Zone 111 in 42.5 overs (Abhijit Sarkar 5/20) & 7/0 in one over.

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

In Jammu & Kashmir's historic Ranji Trophy triumph in 2025-26, Abid Mushtaq was a silent warrior. In 10 matches, he took only 20 wickets, and in the knock-out stages, just four from three games. But on day two of North Zone's Duleep Trophy quarterfinal versus West Zone, the left-arm spinner showed his real worth by picking up his 10th First Class five-wicket haul (five for 39).

Guile and control The 29-year-old was indeed helped by a red-soil pitch that gripped and offered sufficient turn. But Abid also displayed sufficient guile and control, without getting carried away. "I try to bowl within the stumps and it's very difficult to play that," Abid told reporters on Monday. "My plan is to use the crease. Sometimes I bowl from height, and sometimes from the base. I believe in [higher] speed and staying straight." Abid's methods are straight out of the Ravindra Jadeja playbook, and it was for this reason that the visiting Australians signed



Abid celebrates a wicket with Arshdeep. ALLEN EGENUSE J.

him up as a net bowler in 2023 ahead of the Test series. But back home in the Chenab valley of Jammu region, he had few red-soil wickets to practise on. Abid credits his improvement to the better infrastructure now available and also to the support of those like P. Krishna Kumar, J&K's bowling coach for the last three years. "There were more green wickets," Abid said. "Now we have a variety of pitches... red and black soil. When the wicket is of red soil, I have a lot of confidence. I get goose-bumps." No wonder he made the West Zone batters dance to his tune.

India crashes out after another lacklustre show

HOCKEY WORLD CUP

Aashin Prasad
AMSTELVEEN

Sukhjeet Singh put his arms aloft in celebration after scoring a goal in the 57th minute. But it was his side's second to Argentina's five as its World Cup run was nearing the end. It summed up India's day at the Wagener Stadion on Monday. Twenty three years ago, it was in this very arena, where India scripted one of its greatest comebacks, overturning a 2-4 deficit in 15 minutes to beat Pakistan 7-4 in the Champions Trophy. Needing a big win to stay alive in the men's World Cup, there was to be no repeat story from the current class as it went down 5-3. The defeat was India's third in five games in this World Cup. The former champion also let in 16 goals. Finishing last in Pool E, India will play Belgium for the seventh place. India got off to a dreadful start as Argentina capitalised on its defensive errors. Inside 40 seconds, a failed clearance allowed an unmarked Joaquin Toscani slot home for the first.



Cashing in: Argentina made India pay for its defensive errors. HOCKEY INDIA

Four minutes later, indecision from Yashdeep Siwach resulted in the defender conceding a penalty corner, which Nicolas Della Torre pushed low and hard to make it 2-0. India found a lifeline through Sukhjeet as he scored with a backhand finish. Better control prevailed in the second quarter before further mistakes proved to be India's undoing once again. Mohith H.S. could do nothing to stop Tomas Domene's fiercely-struck reverse-hit. Yashdeep's day got only worse when his backpass was intercepted inside the 25 yards before the resulting shot on target struck his foot. Domene made no

mistake from the spot to make it 4-1. With eight minutes to go, Lucas Toscani added a fifth. A late resurgence saw India reduce the margin with another goal from Sukhjeet before Hardik Singh converted a penalty stroke. Argentina progressed to the semifinals after England could only manage a 2-2 draw with the Netherlands later in the day. The Dutch will meet Spain in Friday's first semifinal while Argentina takes on Germany the same day. The result: Argentina 5 (Joaquin Toscani 1, Della Torre 5-pc, Domene 32 & 44-ps, Lucas Toscani 52) bt India 3 (Sukhjeet 9 & 57, Hardik 60-ps).

INBRIEF



Balaji-Anirudh pair triumphs at Cancun Country Open

N. Sriram Balaji and Anirudh Chandrasekar won the doubles title at the Cancun Country Open, defeating the Mexican-Belarusian pairing of Miguel Angel Reyes-Varela and Ivan Liutarevich 6-3, 7-6(4) in the final. The champions earned 125 ranking points along with a \$9,900 prize.

Pratitee emerges sole leader; Mayank remains on top

Pratitee Bordoloi, with six points, emerged as the sole leader in the girls' section after round seven of the Asian junior chess championship in Mumbai. In open event, top seed Mayank Chakraborty maintained his lead with six points.

Important results (seventh round): Open: Mayank Chakraborty 6 drew with Vignesh Venula 5.5; Artem Pingin (Rus) 5.5 drew with Daksh Goyal 5.5; Apoorv Kamble 5 drew with Madhvendra Sharma 5; Amanmuhmmet Hommadov (Tkm) 4.5 lost to Viresh Sharnarhi 5.5; Vivaan Sardana 4.5 drew with Imangali Akhiltbay (Kaz) 4.5; Ilhan Charyyev (Tkm) 4 lost to Arshpreet Singh 5; Jaiveer Mahendru 4 lost to Ahmet Gubatayev (Tkm) 5; V.S. Nandish 4.5 drew with Agnivo Chakraborty 4.5; Siddhant Salunke 5 bt Guru Prakash 4. **Girls:** Aadya Gowda 5 lost to Pratitee Bordoloi 6; Leyla Shohradova (Tkm) 5.5 drew with G. Shivambika 5.5; Mariya Kholjavko (Kaz) 5 drew with Dakshita Kumawat 5; V.C. Nivedita 4.5 lost to Prishita Gupta 5.5; Sravyasree Bheemarasetty 5 bt Shanmathi Sree 4; Sunetra Dey 5 bt Jahan Rejepova (Tkm) 4; Akshaya Sathi 5 bt Anvita Sathi 4; Kasthuri Bhai 4 lost to S. Pranavasri 5; Lala Shohradova (Tkm) 4.5 bt Sanudula Dahamdi (Sri) 3.5; Marium Fatima 4.5 bt Mrittika Mallick 3.5.

England drops pacer Carse for second Test

England pacer Brydon Carse was dropped on Monday for the second Test against Pakistan following the latest off-field incident to affect the national team. Images on social media showed Carse in police handcuffs outside a nightclub in Derby on Saturday night, following a game with his club side Durham. The ECB said Carse will be replaced in the squad by Sonny Baker for the second Test, which starts on Thursday. "Following a referral from ECB, the Cricket Regulator have confirmed that they will investigate the events on Saturday night in Derby," the ECB said on Monday.

LIVE TELECAST

Duleep Trophy: Quarterfinals, Day 3, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.
Sri Lanka vs India: Second Test, Day 3, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 9.45 a.m.
Champions League (play-offs, second-leg): Sony Sports Ten 2, 5 & LIV, 10.15 p.m. & 12.30 a.m. (Wednesday)
LaLiga: FanCode, 12.30 a.m. (Wednesday)

Champion Barcelona steamrollers Elche

EURO LEAGUES

Agencies
ELCHE

Defending champion Barcelona cruised to a 5-0 win over Elche in its LaLiga opener on Sunday, with Raphinha and Fermin Lopez scoring a brace each and Anthony Gordon setting up two goals on his debut.

Karim Adeyemi also found the net on his debut as Barcelona made light work of a vulnerable Elche side at the Martinez Valero stadium.

Manager Hansi Flick had several regular starters on the bench as they continue

to get up to speed after competing in the World Cup.

"Five goals against this team is good because Elche plays fantastic football," said Flick.

"We are really happy that we won 5-0, three points. This is a fantastic start for us. It gives us the confidence which we need for the next matches," added the chief coach.

The results:

LaLiga: Elche 0 lost to Barcelona 5 (Raphinha 14-pen, 67, Adeyemi 45+3, Lopez 71, 79).

Serie A: Torino 1 (Adams 90+3) lost to AC Milan 2 (Cisse 64, Rabiot 67); Frosinone 0 lost to Juventus 1 (Bremer 22).
Atalanta 2 (Raspadori 6, Krstovic 65) bt Sassuolo 1 (Odenthal 55).



Flying start: Raphinha could not have asked for a better beginning to the league season. AP

BENGALURU ROUND-UP

Mohammed bags a double

Mohammed Mustafa clinched a double in the Karnataka State sub-junior ranking billiards and snooker tournament here.

The results (finals):
Billiards: Mohammed Mustafa bt Nachiketa Koushik 284-152.

Snooker: Mohammed Mustafa bt S. Subiksh 34-72, 60-28, 47-32, 41-53, 75-13.

Palar SC (Kolar) emerges champion

With 42 points from 11 matches, Palar SC (Kolar) emerged the KSCA Group I, Division II league champion.

Chintamani SA's Revanth Bairy (942) and Palar SC's Ritesh Bhatkal (70) finished as the league's highest run-getter and wicket-taker.



Proud moment: Palar SC (Kolar), which won the KSCA Group I, Division II league title. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

TABLE TENNIS

Amol Karhadkar
KANPUR

Three weeks ago, he fell two points short of lifting the trophy at the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship (CTTC) in his hometown New Delhi.

But on Sunday here, Payas Jain didn't let history repeat itself. For the 21-year-old, the time since the CTTC has not been about chasing results. It has been about sticking to a process. That process bore fruit in emphatic fashion as Payas outplayed reigning National champion Manav Thakkar to win the season-opening National ranking tournament at The Sportz Hub.

"Nothing has changed," Payas told *The Hindu*. "Before the Commonwealth Championship, I was trying to follow the process. Even after the Commonwealth Championship, I was just trying to follow the process. The Asian Games is coming up, my main goal is to win a medal for India there."



Dreaming big: Payas' next target is an Asian Games medal. FILE PHOTO: SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

What changed, however, was the manner in which Payas went about his business. Against one of the strongest defensive players in Indian men's table tennis, he refused to be hurried. He stayed in the rallies, waited for the opportunity to turn, and passed Manav with the precision that had also been evident in his service receiving.

Everything, he insisted,

was intentional. "Whether it was my body language, shot-making, strategy or tactics. The fact that everything was intentional reflected on the table. I know how Manav plays. He knows how I play. So, I was prepared for everything," Payas said. "It was a great match. I actually played well and I was feeling very confident."

A member of India's Asian Games squad, he put

together a strong domestic season and finished second in the National rankings. He is closing in on a place in the world's top 100. Payas is still awaiting inclusion in the Sports Authority of India's Target Olympic Podium Scheme list of promising athletes. The Asian Games medal, though, remains the bigger target. Sunday's crown was simply another step towards it.

Sports Ministry firm on sticking to selection guidelines for Asian Games

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Sports Ministry is firm on sticking to the selection criteria for the Asian Games and not giving in to external pressure in clearing names that do not make the cut.

The government recently cleared a 492-member list for the upcoming edition in Aichi-Nagoya, leaving out the football and handball teams and excluding several former medallists, leading to protests.

"There is a lot of pressure from all quarters to in-

clude many sportspersons. Many parents call up to say their child deserved a chance but was not selected. But our contention is, if someone merits selection on the basis of the government criteria, he/she will not be ignored but we cannot simply clear names," ministry sources said on Monday.

"For example, if the Asian timing is 10 seconds to be even a contender in 100m, how can we send someone clocking 15s?" they added. The ministry's criteria mandate a top-six in individual and top-eight

placing in team sports in the previous edition with the government having the final say.

There has been a protest over the pruned tennis list, which has seven players including two women and has left out the likes of top-ranked Sahaja Yamalapalli, with former star Rohan Bopanna raising questions. Earlier, paddler Manika Batra had also slammed her exclusion by the federation while rider Anush Agarwal, individual and team medallist in 2023, went to court but was not granted relief.

Meanwhile, a nationwide programme will be organised on August 27 as part of the National Sports Day, celebrated on August 29 to mark the birth anniversary of Major Dhyan Chand.

It will have leading athletes including Manika, Deepa Karmakar, Saina Nehwal, Gagan Narang and P.R. Sreejesh among others sharing their journey, challenges and sporting experiences with youngsters across more than 1500 locations including IITs, IIMs and other leading educational institutions.

Praggnanandhaa beats Keymer, takes the lead



Precision play: Praggnanandhaa came up trumps in a crucial game. FLICKR/GRANDCHESSTOUR

GCT GRAND FINAL

Press Trust of India
ST. LOUIS (USA)

Indian Grandmaster R. Praggnanandhaa defeated Vincent Keymer of Germany in the second classical game to take a 9-3 lead and take a big step towards qualifying for the finals of the concluding event of Grand Chess Tour.

With both players running out of time, Keymer found a way to continue but it was in the second time control that the Indian GM cashed in with the German resigning on the 55th move.

The victory meant that Praggnanandhaa is six points away from making it to the final of the \$450,000 tournament.

There will be two more

rapid games in which the winner gets four points and four blitz games that give two points for a win.

In the other semifinal, Fabiano Caruana of United States let slip a winning position against compatriot Wesley So. Caruana called the shots from the start and showcased his brilliant preparation that led to a huge advantage subsequently. However, So's fighting qualities helped him salvage a draw.

The top three from here will get a direct invite to next year's Grand Chess Tour and this event's winner will receive \$200,000. The runner-up will earn \$125,000 and third-placed player will get \$75,000.

The results: semifinal: classical second game: R. Praggnanandhaa bt Vincent Keymer (Ger); Fabiano Caruana (USA) drew with Wesley So (USA).

United Peela Interface in bread



Singapore u-20 coach impressed with his team's India outing

FOOTBALL

Sports Bureau
BENGALURU

The two closed-door friendly matches against India earlier this month offered Singapore's under-20 men's football team a valuable test of where it stands against strong opposition.

Played at the Centre for Sports Excellence here, the games were part of preparations for the AFC U20 Asian Cup China 2027 qualifiers. India won the encounters 3-0 and 1-0.

For Singapore head coach Syed Azmir, however, the results were secondary to the lessons his players could take from the outings.

"We wanted to test the players against strong opposition, see how well they could execute our principles under pressure and assess different combinations within the team. It was also important to give the players international match exposure and develop their understanding of the intensity, discipline and decision-making required at this level," Azmir said.

"Ultimately, the results are important, but our bigger focus was on the performance, learning from each game and making sure we leave India better prepared than when we arrived."

Intensity

Azmir was impressed by India's performance, particularly the intensity and physicality with which the home side approached both matches.

"What impressed me most about the India under-20 side was their intensity and physicality. They were aggressive in their approach, competed very well in their duels and were able to maintain that intensity throughout both matches. They were also well organised and disciplined in the way they played," he said.

"You could see that they have been together for some time and are preparing seriously for their AFC qualifiers. For our players, it was exactly the type of opposition we wanted. They punished our mistakes and forced us to make decisions quicker, which gave us a very good reference of the level we need to reach," he added.

One of the missions of GCL is to build a fanbase: Rakshit

CHESS

P.K. Ajith Kumar

The third edition of the Global Chess League (GCL) in Mumbai last year proved a big hit with the fans, who were able to engage with their favourite stars at the Royal Opera House. The fourth season of the league, which opens at Bengaluru on September 5, will provide even bigger opportunities for them, according to Gourav Rakshit, the GCL Commissioner.

"After Mumbai, we have a sense of what the Indian fan expects from the GCL, and we are looking forward to making it even bigger and better at Bengaluru," Rakshit told *The Hindu* over the phone. "I think our broadcast also worked extremely well, and the fans at the venue could listen to the commentary of the games through headsets. That novelty was welcomed by the fans. One of the missions of GCL is to build a fanbase of chess."

He said they could look forward to spending more time with the players at Bengaluru. "At the special sections inside the fan zone now, where players can come and actually interact with the fans," he said. "The team owners too can interact with the fans, who will get a chance to experience a close con-



GCL commissioner Rakshit.



This time we have got an app where the fans can actually play along with the GM. The idea is that they could do their moves before the GMs

nection with all the players."

Rakshit said the GCL was developing an app that would give plenty to the chess fans. "Most of our fans are also chess players," he said. "Now this time we have got an app where the fans can actually play along with the Grandmaster. The idea is that they could do their moves before the GMs. And they will get to actually see the live positions that are on the board. We are excited that we will give the fans at home also a different opportunity to experience GCL, not just on the stream, but in action, live inside the app".

In the post-Bazball era, can Brook go from reckless to ruthless?

The England star averages 53.63 after 39 Tests and is No. 1 in the ICC Test rankings, but too often during the regime of Stokes and McCullum as captain and coach, he was prone to rash dismissals. With the steely pair of Root and Fleming taking charge in a bid to revive the fortunes of the Test team, the onus is on the middle-order batter to control his impetuosity and boost his average even further

Vivek Krishnan

With the hallowed Headingley Cricket Ground serving as a backdrop, England's Test team ushered in a new era last week. It was brought upon the Englishmen after Ben Stokes' retirement at the end of a chaos-ridden series defeat to New Zealand in June. Brendon McCullum also had to relinquish his role as Test coach in the aftermath, curtailing his authority to just the white-ball set-up. Joe Root, certainly older and hopefully wiser to the perils of captaincy after his first stint, is back in the hot seat for a second time. The 35-year-old will have another Kiwi coach, Stephen Fleming, by his side when England embarks on a tour of South Africa for three Tests over the winter.

If Root & Co. intended to start with a clean slate and not let the previous regime's ideological inclinations linger, there were encouraging signs against Pakistan in Leeds. The result – victory by an innings and 103 runs inside three days – was just as the doctor ordered for England, but the willingness to change tack was most apparent in how Harry Brook went about his business during his two hours and 22 minutes at the crease.

At a venue he knows like the back of his hand, Brook simply batted, without resorting to any of the gimmicks that entertain and exasperate onlookers in equal measure. Not once did he dance down the track to wallop the ball over extra cover. The shuffle across the stumps for the scoop to fine-leg, another trademark of the Yorkshireman, was also concealed.

Yet, the 27-year-old raced to 91 off 93 deliveries before walking off to a rousing ovation from his home crowd. Even his dismissal was unusually soft – bowled by left-arm spinner Ali Usman while looking to nudge the ball square on the leg-side.

It raises a pertinent question: was Brook's very first innings in the post-Bazball era a pointer to the tweak in approach that Root and Fleming desire from him?

It may appear absurd to quibble about a method that has only yielded outstanding results so far. A bit like nitpicking the song-writing structure of the Beatles. After all, Brook averages 53.63 after 39 Tests. He is one of only three batters since the start of 2020 to average more than 50 in this format. He is currently No. 1 in the International Cricket Council's rankings for Test batters.

More to offer

If there is a sense then that he still isn't optimising his ability to the fullest, it is a testament to his supremely high ceiling as a batter. Such was his incandescent start to life at the highest level that he was actually averaging a remarkable 61.62 after his first 23 Tests. Granted that it is natural for the average to plateau as one plays more Tests, but Brook could have sustained that initial surge if only he had applied himself more. Too often in his Test career, the middle-order dasher, driven by an impetuous streak to unleash

his eclectic range of shots, has succumbed to his impulsiveness. It has been the difference between victory and defeat on some occasions.

The most glaring example came against India at The Oval a year ago. Chasing 374 in the fifth and final Test of a series that had oscillated like a pendulum all through, Brook hammered the Indian attack with nonchalance to take England to the cusp of a storied win. With another 73 runs required and seven wickets in hand, however, Brook committed the schoolboy blunder of assuming that the contest was done and dusted. Instead of aiming to stay through to the end, he swung wildly at a length ball by Akash Deep and holed out at mid-off after a sublime 111 off 98 deliveries. Mohammed Siraj & Co. sensed the narrowest of openings, and seized the initiative to clinch an epic six-run win and level the series 2-2.

If not for that error in judgment, England may have entered the Ashes later in the year with greater impetus and avoided a 1-4 rout. As it turned out, the legacy of Stokes and McCullum as captain and coach was tarnished by the end by their inability to win a series against either India or Australia.

Another nadir in Brook's collection of forgettable dismissals came in the final Test of the last series against New Zealand at Trent Bridge. With Stokes, whose retirement became public midway through the fourth day's play, promoting himself to open in the fourth innings and bowling out with a burst of attacking shots in pursuit of a target of 373, Brook decided to follow his captain's command without hesitation.

He produced a frenetic and frankly bewildering 9-ball 21, and was caught at fine-leg while trying to loft Zak Foulkes into the stands. The hysterical reaction of the New Zealanders – the stump mic picked up Rachin Ravindra chuckling as he muttered, 'what are they doing?' – summed up the imprudence of the stroke.

During the Test against Pakistan, Stuart Broad, who has turned into a shrewd commentator after a stellar playing career, delved into the conundrum facing Brook.

At Headingley, a venue he knows like the back of his hand, Brook simply batted without resorting to any of the gimmicks that entertain and exasperate onlookers in equal measure. Not once did he dance down the track to wallop the ball over extra cover

"He can play in any way that his captain and coach require for the team. McCullum and Stokes wanted him to play in a certain style, and that did play into his strengths. But if we look for improvements in Brook, I feel he could average 60 in Tests. England needs him to get the team over the line in big games. If he had got the job done against India, the narrative would have been different for England going into the Ashes," Broad commented on *Sky Sports Cricket*.

"If he can get through little periods and win those moments, he can be averaging closer to 60. Averages won't matter to him, but it is more about being the guy who wins Test matches at important times. There are some instances when he hasn't done that. Because he is so talented, we expect much more from him," the former fast bowler continued.

Brook's knock against Pakistan may be a sign that he is coming of age. The relatively measured tempo may have also had to do with the sheer incompetence of the Pakistan attack, for he knew that he did not have to manufacture boundary-scoring opportunities when a rank bad ball was on offer in every over. Even then, it is a step in the right direction for Brook to have had that situational awareness.

The trigger

When he has displayed daredevilry on previous occasions, he has done so to usually counter either a tricky surface or a formidable bowling attack that has homed in on a stifling channel.

While there is some cricketing logic to such an outlook, there is a fine line between being proactive and plain foolish. In Brook's case, he has tended to veer towards the latter.

The recklessness has extended beyond the field too. Think of the nightclub incident in Wellington on the eve of an ODI against New Zealand last October, when Brook was at the centre of an altercation with a bouncer. It was far from adhering to the standards of professionalism expected of an elite cricketer in the 2020s, not least because he was also white-ball captain.

Even if the top honchos of the England & Wales Cricket Board (ECB) don't concede, it would have had a bearing on the decision to not let Brook take charge of the Test team at this point. It may be to England's detriment, for he has shown a flair for leadership in helping the ODI and T20I teams regain their mojo under his watch. He led the two-time champion to the semifinals of the T20 World Cup in March, and also spearheaded T20I and ODI series wins against India at home in July.

"Harry makes a really good captain. He has a good presence and a very good cricket brain. I personally would have preferred England going with Brook as Test captain. It would have been a forward-looking step.

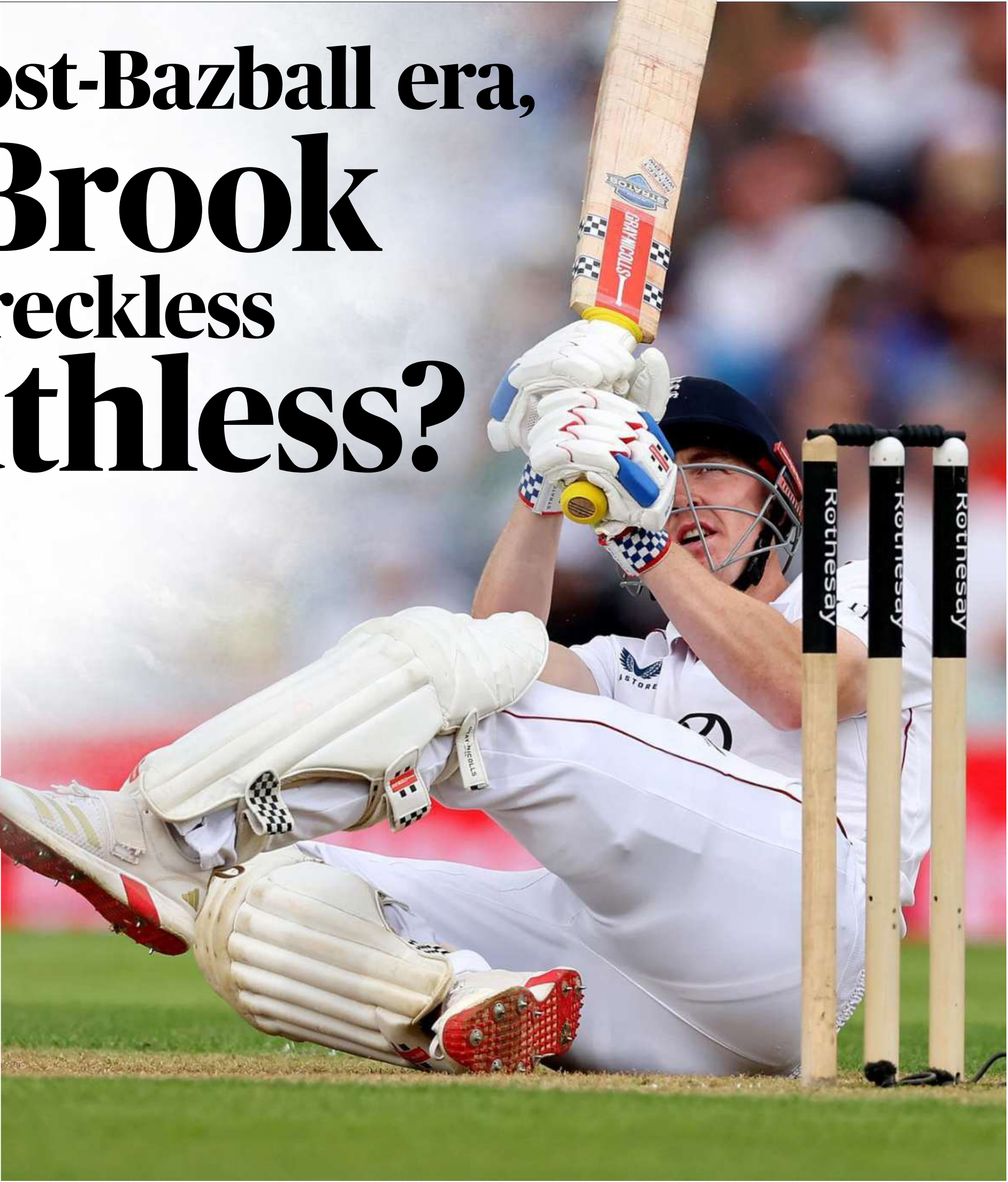
There is obviously the issue of what Harry has done off the field," former England skipper Nasser Hussain observed in the discussion with Broad. Some of Brook's indiscretions shouldn't give the impression that he doesn't quite care. If that was the case, he wouldn't have pulled out of the IPL in 2025 and invited a two-year ban from the T20 league because he wanted to wholeheartedly focus on his commitments with England. "It is a really important time for England cricket, and I want to fully commit to preparing for the upcoming series. In order to do this, I need time to recharge after the busiest period in my career to date," Brook said at the time of his decision.

Now, the time is ripe for Brook, approaching the prime of his career, to show that his template last week wasn't a one-off. If he can buckle down and become ruthless, England's new era under Root and Fleming can strive to accomplish series wins against elite opponents. Something that Bazball never managed.

THE GIST

Brook's knock against Pakistan may be a sign that he is coming of age. The relatively measured tempo may have also had to do with the sheer incompetence of the Pakistan attack, for he knew that he did not have to manufacture boundary-scoring opportunities when a rank bad ball was on offer in every over

Too often in his Test career, the middle-order dasher, driven by an impetuous streak to unleash his eclectic range of shots, has succumbed to his impulsiveness. It has been the difference between victory and defeat on some occasions



Alok Bhattacharya
Gayatri Saberwal

What Galileo missed

U.K. forecasts 'biggest' El Niño yet will break heat records

S BG-BGE

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of polling stations in Delhi after the SIR exercise

14,947 The number of polling stations in Delhi has gone up to 14,947 from 13,033 after rationalisation under the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) exercise. The number of polling-station locations has also increased from 2,696 to 2,856, according to a statement by the Delhi chief electoral officer (CEO) on Monday. PTI

Number of weeks for CPCB to fix standards for 3 new pollutants

10 The National Green Tribunal has allowed the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) 10 weeks to standardise the methods for testing three new parameters or pollutants in ambient air. The three new pollutant in ambient air are aluminium, iron and silica. At present, the CPCB tracks 12 major pollutants under the National Ambient Air Quality Standards (NAAQS). PTI

Number of airports to be awarded to private players by the govt.

11 The government plans to award 11 airports, including those at Varanasi and Tirupati, to private players in five bundles under the public-private-partnership model. The Civil Aviation Ministry has proposed the private partners for 11 airports, grouped into five bundles, with each bundle to be awarded to a single concessionaire, according to an official document. PTI

Percentage increase in average retail price of onion year-on-year

59 in per cent. Data maintained by the Centre shows that the all-India average retail price of onion rose 59 per cent year-on-year to ₹43.53/kg on August 24, from ₹ 27.37/kg a year ago. The Centre has started moving bulk onion stocks through dedicated railway rakes – the ‘Kanda Express’ – from Nashik in Maharashtra to major consuming centres. PTI

Bills passed in the Karnataka Legislative Assembly on Monday

8 Eight Bills, including the one allowing portions of park and garden land to be used for public infrastructure and utility projects, were passed by the Karnataka Legislative Assembly on Monday without discussion, amid the Opposition’s protest demanding the resignation of Cabinet Minister B. Nagendra. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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How the SC ruling redefined ‘industry’

The majority held that ‘industry’ under the IRC must be interpreted based on its own specific text and statutory context, unburdened by the legacy of the 1978 precedent; Justices B.V. Nagarathna, Dipankar Datta, and Ujjal Bhuyan formed the minority view that a re-evaluation of the 1978 judgment was ‘unwarranted’

EXPLAINER

Krishnadas Rajagopal

The story so far:

A nine-member Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court of India recently held that the nearly half-century-old interpretation of the term ‘industry’ will not automatically apply to the Industrial Relations Code (IRC), 2020, which came into force in November 2025 and replaced the legacy Industrial Disputes Act, 1947. This decision effectively severs the new labour regime from an expansive, worker-friendly precedent set in 1978, establishing a clean slate for future labour law disputes.

The scope of ‘industry’

To understand the significance of this judgment, one must look back to the historic 1978 ruling in *Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board v. R. Rajappa*. Authored by Justice V.R. Krishna Iyer, that seven-judge Bench significantly broadened the definition of Section 2(j) under the 1947 Act. The 1978 judgment introduced the triple test, which classified systematic or organised operations based on employer-employee cooperation to provide goods or services for consumers as an industry.

This sweeping definition brought various activities, including hospitals, educational institutions, and municipalities, under the legal definition of an industry. The only exclusions were core sovereign functions of the state, such as defence, judiciary, and law enforcement. For nearly half a century, this judgment had enabled workers across diverse sectors to access legal recourse, enforce labour rights, and engage in collective bargaining against unfair practices.

The crux of the judgment

The Constitution Bench, led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, addressed the



Word of caution: Justice B.V. Nagarathna stressed that altering the definition of industry could create uncertainty and disrupt industrial peace. AFP

question whether the 1978 definition of ‘industry’ should govern Section 2(p) of the IRC.

The majority held that ‘industry’ under the IRC must be interpreted based on its own specific text and statutory context, unburdened by the legacy of the 1978 precedent. Chief Justice Kant noted that while the core principles of the 1978 ruling had stood the test of time, the 1978 judgment would no longer act as the “sheet anchor” for interpreting ‘industry’ under the IRC.

Pending cases under the 1947 Act will continue to be governed by the 1978 Bangalore Water Supply precedent. All future disputes governed by the new Industrial Relations Code will be interpreted afresh.

Differing points of view on the Bench

The nine-judge Bench reflected nuanced positions on the balance between worker

protections and modern economic realities.

An opinion authored by Chief Justice Kant, and shared with Justices Satish Chandra Sharma, Alok Aradhe and Vipul M. Pancholi, held that the ‘triple test’ of 1978 Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board case judgment will continue to be applied to pending industrial disputes.

The Chief Justice, however, found that the 1978 verdict could have been articulated differently and set down a “reformulated” triple test, which would operate prospectively. However, the possibility of using the recast triple test to determine if an operation was an industry or not under Section 2(j) of the repealed 1947 Act is non-existent as the new labour law, The Industrial Relations Code 2020, has already come into force. The Bench has unanimously made it clear that ‘industry’ under the 2020 Code will be

“interpreted independently” to align with contemporary industrial dynamics, and not be burdened by the 1978 verdict.

Justices B.V. Nagarathna, Dipankar Datta, and Ujjal Bhuyan formed the minority view on the Bench that a re-evaluation of the 1978 judgment was “unwarranted”. Justice Nagarathna cautioned that altering the definition could create uncertainty and disrupt industrial peace.

Justice Nagarathna argued that the 1978 judgment had offered a broad-based definition of ‘industry’. She highlighted that the judgment was a child of its time, when public sector workers were transitioning into private employment due to a changing industrial landscape inspired by privatisation, liberalisation and globalisation of the Indian economy.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi supported the need for the reference to the nine-judge Bench, but expressed his inability to agree to a “reformulated” triple test. Justice Bagchi said an apprehension that the triple test conceived in the 1978 judgment converted any organised activity into an industry was misplaced.

The judge agreed with Justice Nagarathna that even the state could enter into seemingly non-sovereign functions. The concept of ‘sovereignty’ has itself undergone changes with the passage of time. Absence of a profit motive did not take an activity outside the realm of industry, he observed. He said it was unwise to “re-draft” Justice Iyer’s triple test. Justice Datta echoed the need for judicial consistency. Sharing his opinion with Justice Bhuyan, Justice Datta remarked that institutional credibility relies on respecting finality rather than perpetuating doubt over established law.

A step towards a new era

By severing the IRC from the 1978 precedent, the Supreme Court has set the stage for a new chapter in Indian labour law, leaving it to future courts to decide where the lines between employer authority and worker protections will ultimately be drawn.

THE GIST

A nine-member Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court recently held that the nearly half-century-old interpretation of the term ‘industry’ will not automatically apply to the Industrial Relations Code, 2020.

A 1978 ruling had introduced the triple test, which classified organised operations based on employer-employee cooperation to provide goods or services for consumers as an industry. This judgment had enabled workers across diverse sectors to enforce labour rights.

Did Press Note 3 relaxations help attract more FDI?

The Centre says that 29 FDI projects worth ₹4,895.65 cr. had been reported to it under the revised framework

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan

The story so far

The Union government on Friday said that India had received foreign direct investment (FDI) worth ₹4,895 over just the last few months, from companies that have benefitted from recent relaxations made to India’s FDI rules.

The aim of the relaxations was precisely to ease the flow of investments that had earlier been locked out of India.

What was the earlier rule?

The Union government had issued Press Note 3 in April 2020, in which it amended India’s FDI policy. The existing rule at the time stated that any entity of Bangladesh and Pakistan could invest in India only after securing Government approval. Press Note 3 widened this stipulation to

include any country that shared a land border with India. So, this included Pakistan, China, Bangladesh, Nepal, and Bhutan.

The popular perception is that the government took this decision as a result of border clashes between India and China at Galwan.

However, Press Note 3 was issued in April 2020, before those clashes took place in May.

The reason the change was made was to prevent hostile takeovers of companies ailing due to the COVID-19 pandemic. India and a few other countries had noticed that, early on in the pandemic, Chinese companies were buying up majority stakes in companies in the countries whose stock prices had plummeted due to the pandemic. The FDI restriction was aimed at curbing this.

While the origin of the rule was not directly linked to the border clashes, its

extension over the years was certainly a result of the frigid relationship between India and China.

What was the relaxation?

In March 2026, the Centre eased the Press Note 3 restrictions somewhat. It said that FDI from entities would be allowed in India through the automatic route, without needing express government approval, if these entities had less than 10% stake based in countries that share a land border with India.

In other words, companies that had minority and non-controlling stakes held by these land-border countries could invest in India through the easier route.

The government did this because it said that a lot of investment into India had been held up because even companies that had tiny stakes owned by Chinese entities faced stricter restrictions on their investments into India.

“It is expected that the new guidelines will provide clarity and ease of doing business in India, and facilitate investments which can contribute towards greater FDI inflows, access to new technologies, domestic value addition, expansion of domestic firms and integration with global supply chain,” the government had said in March when it eased the rules.

What has been the benefit?

The Ministry of Commerce and Industry said on Friday that a total of 29 FDI projects worth ₹4,895.65 crore had been reported to it under its revised framework up to August 10, 2026.

It added that these investments span a range of sectors, including information technology, artificial intelligence, information and communication, manufacturing, pharmaceuticals, data centres and transport services, among others.

Further, the investments have come from several countries, including Mauritius, the U.S., the Republic of Korea, Japan, Singapore, Luxembourg, and the Cayman Islands.

In relative terms, this investment amount is not all that significant. For instance, it amounts to less than 1% of the total FDI India received in 2025-26. But it is still early days, and for India and FDI, every little bit helps.

THE GIST

The Union government had issued Press Note 3 in April 2020, stipulating that any country sharing a land border with India could invest in the country only after securing Government approval.

In March 2026, the Centre eased the Press Note 3 restrictions somewhat. It said that FDI from entities would be allowed in India through the automatic route, without needing express government approval, if these entities had less than 10% stake based in countries that share a land border with India.

